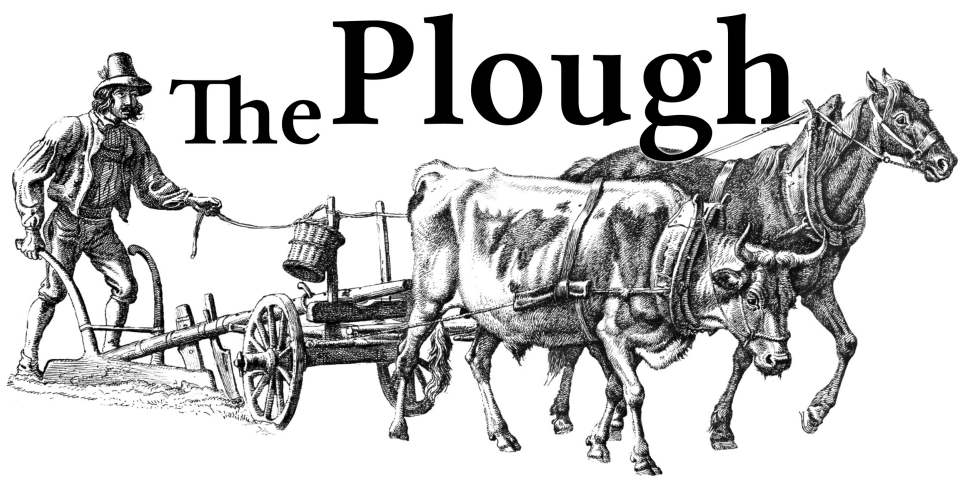




The Plough

Featuring

The Ethics of Consumption

Arthur Penty

Must our goods be cheap and nasty until the end of time? Or is there some moral imperative that must move our consumption, along with our soul, upwards?

pg. 4



Book Review: Piers Plowman

Theodore Xavier

The English poetical classic is steeped in Christian allegory. This work predates, and even influences Chaucer's *Canturbury Tales*. Our author gives a review of the poem from a modern perspective.

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Issue August 2026

The Primary Allegiance of the Jews

Fr Denis Fahey

In the life of a nation, the community of families sharing blood and soil, what place do the Jews play? Fr Fahey lays out some principles.

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NEMO MITTENS MANUM SUAM AD ARATRUM, ET RESPICIENS RETRO, APTUS EST REGNO DEI
NO MAN PUTTING HIS HAND TO THE PLOUGH, AND LOOKING BACK, IS FIT FOR THE KINGDOM OF GOD

The Old Urbanism: Part I

Why Without it a Truly Integral Catholic Culture is Absolutely Impossible

Josue Hernandez

In the summer of 2020, amidst the chaos and uncertainty of that unhappy time, our author's family having lost its longstanding business and him having just learned that his wife was expecting their first child, with no source of income and unable to afford a house, he set out to build a town.

Our Lord explains in the Parable of the Sower that the seed of His love will only grow in a certain soil—and that is the soil of Christian Culture, which is the work of music in the wide sense, including as well as tunes that are sung, art, literature, games, architecture—all so many instruments in the orchestra which plays day and night the music of lovers; and if it is disordered, then the love of Christ will not grow. ...The restoration of culture, spiritually, morally, physically, demands the cultivation of the soil in which the love of Christ can grow, and that means we must, as they say, rethink priorities...

— John Senior, *The Restoration of Christian Culture*

John Senior, that apostle of Christendom and lone voice calling out from the spiritual desert of the last century, describes the soil of Christian culture as *"the natural environment of truth, assisted by art, ordered intrinsically"*

lly... to the praise, reverence and service of God Our Lord". In other words, Christian culture is the milieu in which the worship of God is both cultivated and made manifest in society, the seedbed that feeds and nurtures the natural and supernatural ends that together make up the common good. But if Christian culture is prerequisite for a healthy and rightly ordered society, what then is required for the flourishing of culture itself?

Since the nearly complete triumph of our modern era of progress over and against the supposed ignorance and superstition of an embarrassingly crude and unenlightened past, a nagging suspicion has been growing within many a disillusioned and spiritually starved soul. An uneasy feeling that, more and more quickly, turns into a realization that we have, in many ways, been the victims of a catastrophic sleight of hand. Fooled, as it were, by a deliberately fabricated patchwork of lies that has been repeatedly presented to us our entire lives, we have unwittingly exchanged our birthrights, as heirs of the most noble cultural inheritance, for the absolute mess of pottage that is the spiritually impoverished dark-age in which we live.

Thankfully, where the darkness of sin abounds the bright light of grace abounds all the more, and so there has been a budding reaction to this suicidal descent into barbarism which, though still quite small, has been increasingly garnering momentum and has even now begun to bear what are not insignificant fruits. This awakening can be

en most clearly — as much by its advancements as by the raging opposition it conjures from its enemies—in the area of liturgy. The besieged traditional Roman Rite forms, as it must, the beating heart of this recalcitrant counter-revolution, this new and unabashed reconquest, wherein the faithful sons and daughters of Holy Mother Church advance the banner of Christ the King for the restoration of all things in Him.

It is perhaps the liturgical renaissance that has laid bare the poverty present in other spheres of life—in music, art, literature, architecture, political and economic thought, education, agriculture and so on, reaching all the way down to the forgotten seasonal household customs of the family throughout the year—and occasioned a desire for a rediscovery of the neglected treasures of our rich cultural patrimony. Various burgeoning movements working towards their recovery have taken deep root within our newly emerging communities, promising a future flourishing and abundant harvest—but can these sundry efforts properly nourish the kind of soil where *the seed of His love will grow*?

As positive and praiseworthy as the aforementioned developments may be (and, indeed, there is very much to praise and take hope from), I would argue—in fact, I will absolutely insist—that there is in all of it a missing element without which every advancement will be stunted, fail to culminate in anything resembling a restoration of Christian culture, and ultimately prove to have been for naught.

Physical Communities, the Primordial Soil of Culture

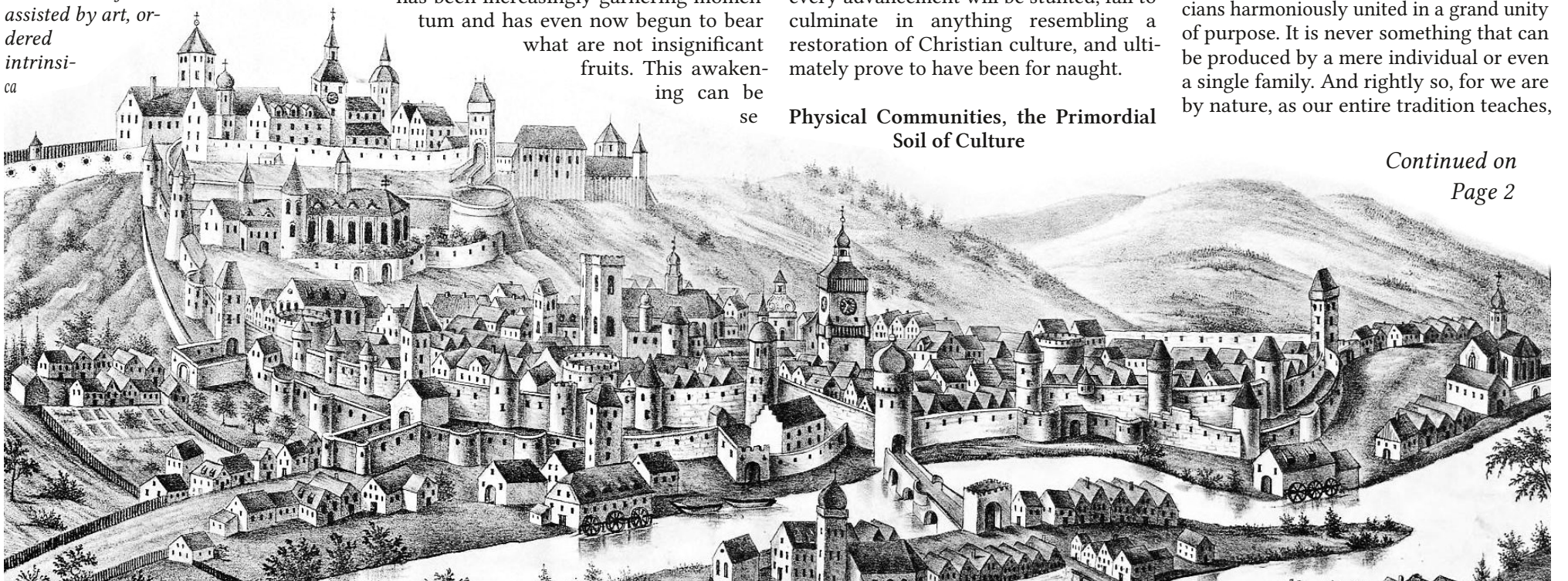
"Since the nearly complete triumph of our modern era of progress over and against the supposed ignorance and superstition of an embarrassingly crude and unenlightened past, a nagging suspicion has been growing within many a disillusioned and spiritually starved soul."

Sweet Auburn! loveliest village of the plain, where health and plenty cheer'd the labouring swain, where smiling spring its earliest visit paid, and parting summer's lingering blooms delayed: dear lovely bowers of innocence and ease, seats of my youth, when every sport could please, how often have I paus'd on every charm, The sheltered cot, the cultivated farm, the never-failing brook, the busy mill, the decent church that topp'd the neighboring hill.

— The Deserted Village, Oliver Goldsmith

Let us begin by stating what ought to be obvious: community is an absolutely necessary prerequisite for culture. The musical symphony that is culture (to say nothing of civilization) requires a diversity of musicians harmoniously united in a grand unity of purpose. It is never something that can be produced by a mere individual or even a single family. And rightly so, for we are by nature, as our entire tradition teaches,

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The Old Urbanism: Part I Cont.

Continued from Page 1

political animals who can only find their true purpose and flourishing within the context of community.

However, and perhaps less obvious to us uprooted, placeless moderns is the fact that—despite what we may have naively been fooled into believing through the influence of our increasingly displaced and ephemeral modes of life—we cannot have, or hope to ever build, real community without the actual physical proximity and fixity of place through which those relationships that form community are able to be cultivated and nurtured.

We are incarnate beings—not disembodied minds floating through the ether. We are flesh-and-blood creatures dwelling within a sacramental cosmos and we require the proper physical structures necessary for human flourishing—which means that we have to create and inhabit the kinds of environments that foster com-

munity.

And, I might add,—and God forgive those who even consider this—you cannot have remote communities based on placeless, digital “social” networks; even if such networks serve as an evermore compulsory means of communication and as an even necessary form of staying “in contact” with others and, at times, may even result in the occasional physical gathering. Real community, by contrast, requires not only physical interaction but a sense of permanence, together with proximity, that allows authentic interactions to be a regular occurrence of everyday life.

Planned visits meticulously scheduled, days and even weeks and months in advance (however regular and consistent they may be), do not offer the social sustenance required for community, for community demands the little noticed, and oft-forgotten, essential ingredient of spontaneity. The knock on the door by the neighbor offering freshly baked goods, the

friend down the block stopping by to see if we’re up for a drink, the chance meetings with familiar faces as we go about our daily affairs or enjoy a moment of recreation – these kinds of encounters and artifacts of community life are all completely dependent on the way in which we order our physical living environments. There is no technological substitute for them, and never will be.

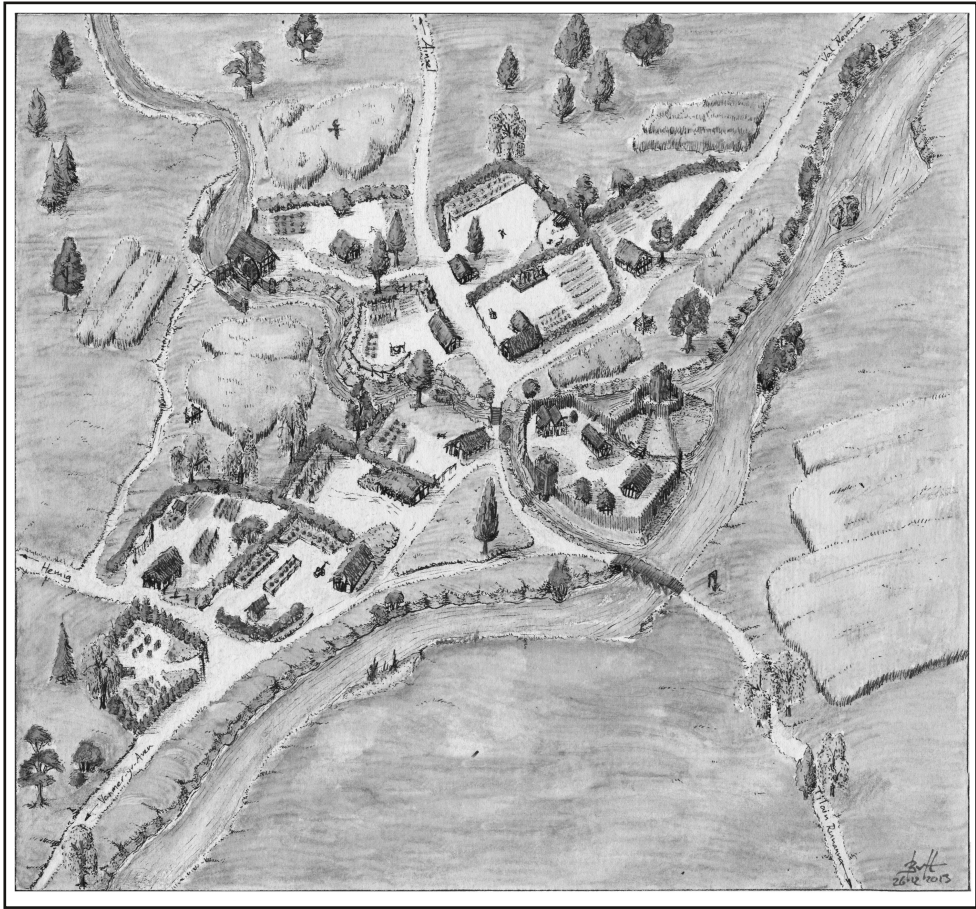
Our anti-incarnational, digital environments are, in fact, the “cultural” manifestations of a gnostic and dualistic (one can add, *trans-humanist*) ideology. A religion. Or, more accurately, an *anti-religion*, manifesting what can only be properly described as an *anti-culture*.¹ However, in many ways the ongoing digitization and physical disembodiment of every function and aspect of our lives form but the latest stage of an ongoing revolution that began with the destruction of the traditional town and village more than a century ago—and which progresses ever towards the complete alienation of man from man and, ultimately, God.

“Planned visits meticulously scheduled, days and even weeks and months in advance (however regular and consistent they may be), do not offer the social sustenance required for community, for community demands the little noticed, and oft-forgotten, essential ingredient of spontaneity.”

lots; placeless, homogenized suburbs; and generally gargantuan environs that grossly violate any notion of human scale set within a disorienting landscape lacking any kind of physical center or spacial cohesiveness, it is difficult, living as long as we have in such spaces, to stress just how much of a seismic shift has occurred, only within the span of a few generations, in the way we as human beings view and interact with the external world around us (and that is to say nothing of the vapid, uninspired and materially impoverished architecture itself).

A monumental change was imposed on society through the proliferation of the automobile. I say imposed because this transformation was not so much due to the initial demand of the people but, rather, as is often the case, to the chicanery and massive lobbying of industry. It was pressure from the automobile lobby that brought about the government subsidization of the destructively expansive highway systems and subsequently, through deranged zoning and traffic codes, the institutionalization of sprawl that, in effect, enthroned the car and traffic congestion as the pinnacle and *summum bonum* of urban life.

Contrary to the promise that, due to the speed of the motorcar, distances would drastically dissipate and make for a more cohesive and interconnected society, we have instead experienced a world in which enormous lengths must be traversed using expensive machines—that are now absolutely required, and from whose use are



Men of our ilk need to re-learn how to act corporately, like our forefathers, in order to rebuild Christendom. Corporate action must take place in a medium, and that medium is our physical co-location.

The Desolation of Our Built Environments

These were thy charms, sweet village; sports like these, with sweet succession taught e'en toil to please; these round thy bowers their cheerful influence shed, these were thy charms—but all these charms are fled.

— The Deserted Village, Oliver Goldsmith

The modern world will not be punished. It is the punishment.

— Nicolás Gómez Dávila

For those of us living among the bleak, spiritually sterile ruins so dispassionately referred to by the technical term of *urban sprawl*, more accurately described as the *abomination of desolation* of our built environments spreading endlessly across our collective living spaces like a cancerous growth—particularly those of us living in North America—characterized by the domination of expansive highways; ever wider multilane roads; strip malls; giant parking

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Ein Mann, ein Wort!

A Man, A Word!

Bishop Tihamer Toth

From Young Man of Character, originally published in Hungarian in the 1930s.

But maybe there are cases when it is permissible to lie? There are boys who excuse themselves very quickly. “I lied for a joke! That cannot be a sin! I harmed nobody with it!” Not a serious sin, but still a sin. You may have harmed nobody else with it, but you harmed yourself. *Wer lügt, betrügt*—Whoever lies, is deceived.

The biggest problem with the so-called innocent lies is that they get you used to more serious lies. Great characters protect themselves from these with care. We find examples of this even among pagans. You have learned about Aristides (530–468 B.C.), the Athenian general and statesman, that he never lied, not even for a joke: “*Aristides adeo fuit veritatis diligens, ut ne joco quidem mentiretur.*”

It is important to see clearly what a lie is. A lie is not telling the truth in order to mislead someone. So if one is merely playing, jesting, wants only amusement, then there is no lie involved. What is forbidden is to mislead others.

I admit that once in a while one may have to choose between a lie and a serious trouble. The principle must remain sacred and inviolable: “I will never lie!” On the other hand, there is the threat of serious trouble which will result from my telling the truth. What to do? A simple solution may be silence. We give no answer. The other side will realize that the question is troublesome for us, and he may stop insisting on an answer. If someone is clever one may give an evasive answer—evade, shirk, blur the issue, talk beside the point, find a plausible excuse or pass it off with a joke. But often these are not accepted, and then nothing else remains but to live with the troublesome consequences.

So, if possible, try to avoid trouble, but if that is not possible, *fiat iustitia et pereat mundus*, let there be justice, though the world perish. Consistently telling the truth is not easy, it is the virtue of heroes!

One easily forgives little children: they lie out of fear of punishment. They are far from having character. But what to say about older boys on their way to growing up, proud of their intellect, courage and honor; it is sad when they prove to be cowards and try to escape a well-deserved punishment with a lie.

How much more impressive is the character of the young man who never lies because he is simply not able to lie. He is candid, simple-hearted, to lie would do violence against him. How wonderful it is to meet such a young man on whose word one can always rely and build, whose words are true like Holy Scripture. *Ein Mann, ein Wort!*

God wanted to make it difficult for man to lie, so He made man in such a way that he blushes when he lies. It is possible to learn to lie without blushing (“as if he read it from a book”), but it is a cursed science! So, my son, be proud of your truthfulness! And every boy who cares the least bit about his honor, manliness and character should be veracious to the last word. The boy who lies easily attacks the foundations of his character, and inescapably heads for moral disintegration. Whoever violates the truth will not be faithful to his duties either. Whoever wants to get ahead with untrustworthy speech will be dishonorable in life too: he will be bribed as a public official, he

will cheat as a merchant; whatever he is, he will have no character. Even if it may not be true literally, it is true substantially: “You start with lies, you end on the gallows.”

The motto of the young man of character: Truth at all cost! Holy Scripture says: “If any man offend not in word, the same is a perfect man” (James 3:2). Denying the truth is the surrender of human dignity and the betrayal of our sacred human obligations. I know of no circumstances under which it would be permissible to lie and risk our veracity. Never! No need ever justifies it! I know that some boys try to say: “This time, I simply had to lie” but it is only an excuse. You never have to lie. If we just once concede the necessity of lies it means the end of law; from then on everybody can use it as a defense that “this time it was impossible to avoid lying.”

What would happen to society if lies were tolerated! Nobody could believe another person. The boy could not believe his parents, the parents could not believe their children. Every moment I would have to say: this person is trying to cheat me. I would not dare eat my soup because it might have been poisoned by the cook. I would not dare call a doctor because he might try to kill me, etc. Life would become impossible. Lies are incompatible with human society.



The Old Urbanism: Part I Cont.

Continued from Page 2

excluded the young as well as the old—in order to reach the remote distances artificially created by city codes that protect, through the coercive power of the state, the inhuman and desolate landscapes they have themselves generated through the embrace of bureaucratic madness. Instead of contracting and allowing for more inter-relatedness, our urban environments have stretched endlessly outward swallowing up vast swaths of our precious arable lands and beloved natural landscapes—while also razing to the ground once bustling inter-city neighborhoods and displacing tens of thousands of their residents along the way—in order to create the homogenized blob of highways, overpasses and parking lots that forcibly coral and take hostage everything from the parish church and village green, to the corner store and walking schoolboy, to the point where it has begun (and now nearly completed) cutting its grotesque anti-social figure into our very minds and habits of life.

This radical change in our most basic daily customs—this complete revolution in physical habitat—has had enormous consequences with regards to our ability to form and even retain community. The idyllic small-town and village settlements of the past that are now so nostalgically yearned for have become, not only impossible, but due to building and zoning regulations, almost entirely illegal. Community life has quite literally been criminalized. The quaint American small town with its charming walkable main-street, the splendid cities of the New Spains with their signature *plazas mayores*, the bucolic medieval village, the Italian city-state, and stretching all the way back to Antiquity, the Greek polis—the sort of arrangement that has formed the common experience of most human beings has become a nearly extinct novelty.

The So Called “New Urbanism”

As a response to the dismantling of our built environments—whose urban (and consequently also rural) destruction, itself the logical consequence of the progressive and industrial elements that began to dom-

inate Western societies in the 19th century, came into full force during the post-World War II period and has only accelerated since—there arose a reaction that was eventually galvanized into an organized movement, later to be termed The New Urbanism.

Through their observations and study of old villages, towns and cities—consider, for instance, the grandeur of Rome or the charming homeliness of the small villages and hamlets of England’s Cotswolds region—they distilled a set of principles that universally conformed to every lovable and properly functioning human habitat. As opposed to the urban sprawl or suburban model—where the automobile takes pride of place over the pedestrian, and where neighborhoods, towns and cities—indeed, our lives—are segregated by their function and use (commercial, retail and residential zones) forcibly separating and distancing one from the other and thus necessitating the use of the automobile and ensuring that daily social interaction only take place between cars rather than people—the New Urbanists’ desired aim was the creation of walkable environments, where family and friends, church, school, marketplace and work could be drawn together within close proximity of one another to form an integrated whole. Their objective could be summed up as the following: to create human-scaled, mixed-use (meaning, allowing for the integration of home and workplace, stores and neighborhoods, etc.), pedestrian-friendly environments that facilitate community and human flourishing—rather than being antithetical to them. Not only would such principles make for a significantly higher quality of life but would consequently also dramatically increase the efficient use of available land and space. (It may be difficult for the average American to wrap his head around the fact that the traffic congestion and endless expansion of sprawl that we continuously encounter as the very air we breathe has in fact not been the result of necessity due to a combination of population growth and land scarcity, as is commonly concluded, but rather has been something artificially created by design.)

Although much has been achieved by

way of the numerous New Urbanist developments that have been built over the decades,² operating entirely within the erosive market forces and lacking the necessary cohesive and robust cultural framework that promotes long-term economic viability (by which I mean a strong, interconnected local economy of the various social classes that can supply for a large portion of the necessary jobs and material needs of the community) the developments have tended to become stale, artificial communities of the more well-to-do—often coming to resemble more of a theme park than a true organically functioning neighborhood or town—where less affluent families (or those simply left out due to lack of supply) drive in on the weekend in order to escape the lifeless monotony of the suburbs for the span of an afternoon in order to experience, if for just a brief moment, a trifling taste (in a commercialized, flavorless and watered-down form) of some of the lost charms of urban life. It can be said that many of these places tend to become victims of their own “success” in that desirability and demand to live in them becomes so high that the initial affordable entry level prices which would allow for young families and the working classes to purchase homes in them quickly skyrocket to obscene heights barring any possibility of achieving an integrated economic social strata that is one of the fundamental components of any authentic community life. These homes are often even then put into a rental pool to service a growing tourist market.

This is in no way the fault of New Urbanism’s proponents, working as they must with the available raw social material that they are invariably presented with. In fact, many of the movement’s leaders have been tirelessly working to help create a subsidiary model of incremental development to, in effect, both cut through the bureaucratic red-tape and devise creative financial solutions that would allow for more organic grass-roots developments of such communities. In addition, many of their most successful efforts have been accomplished by way of retrofitting the problematic urban and suburban landscapes through infill and through

“Through their observations and study of old villages, towns and cities—consider, for instance, the grandeur of Rome or the charming homeliness of the small villages and hamlets of England’s Cotswolds region—they distilled a set of principles that universally conformed to every lovable and properly functioning human habitat.”

restructurings, as well as very creative reinterpretations, of zoning codes through a form of bureaucratic judo. This serves as an important reminder that communities aren’t necessarily always best created out of whole cloth. Many times the best place to start is where you already are.

Agrarian or Urban?

To be continued...

1. I say all this as I type on a computer and as you read from a digital screen. Such is the modern predicament that we all find ourselves in. We are like the man who makes use of the wood from the tree that fell and crushed his legs in order to fashion a set of crutches that allow him at least some limited mobility amidst his lame state. Certainly, like this unfortunate man, we use what we must to get by. But let us not be like the fool who praises the fallen tree because, as he says, “without its falling and making me lame I would never have had the wood available to make the crutches that now give me the ability to stumble about the earth forever as a cripple”. Our thinking and approach to technology, I’m convinced, must be much more radical—by orders of magnitude. Certainly, I don’t believe that we should look to one uniform approach in addressing the problem (except, of course, with regard to Senior’s command that we literally smash the television— and I could name a few other such devices to which the same course of action would, more than likely, be the correct one), but I can at the very least say this: let us not fear the Amish; rather, let us learn from their wisdom. A return to the simplicity of the Shire is not a retreat, it is a formidable advance in the direction of sanity. An escape from the shadow of civilizational darkness and a moving forward into the clear light of day. Until we can see this, I fear there will be little hope, if any, for an authentic restoration of Christian culture.

2. Seaside, FL, Serenbe, GA, Cayala, GT, Poundbury, UK, etc.

Cheerfulness Meditations for Layfolk

Fr Bede Jarrett

From Meditations for Layfolk, published in 1915.

Sin excepted, says Saint Francis of Sales, that gay-hearted servant of God, there is nothing that does such harm as melancholy: and Saint Catherine of Siena goes even farther, for in one of these delightful letters of hers to her friends which are so alive with charm and banter, she writes to a young man who fancied that he had to be particularly gloomy because he wished to appear as a poet: "Is not sorrow the worst of all our sins?" It is true that this is merely a question, and therefore it may be said that she does not say that sorrow is so desperate a thing, but only asks whether it is or not; yet even so for such a saint, with all a saint's horror of sin and her exquisite appreciation of the majesty of God, to declare melancholy worse than all other offences or even to ask whether it is so or not, is a very large step to take; but it is one that is perhaps of very great importance for us to take also. Saint Catharine is, indeed, famous for the exact theology of all her writings, so

that we have no business to shrug our shoulders and put it all down to a woman's exaggeration. Nor need we go very far from our own hearts to find the precise meaning of this seemingly astonishing remark. We have only got to watch ourselves when we are really at our worst, to understand the deep meaning of it and also to take comfort for ourselves in its lesson. Every priest who has had to deal with souls, anyone whose privilege it has been to share the secrets of another's experience, will repeat the same story. There is nothing that does us more harm than the feeling of melancholy or discouragement or hopelessness that too often comes over us when we have tried really hard and then fallen.

It is clear that neither Saint Francis of Sales nor Saint Catherine could ever really have meant that sorrow was, in so far that it is sinful, greater in gravity than any other sin; obviously all that they are referring to in sorrow are its effects on the soul, and here there is certainly reason in abundance for their saying. After all, it is not the fact that we have fallen that does us so much harm, but that discouragement makes us lie fallen, that the worst comes. To have spurned God's love is, indeed, a terrible outrage on things human and divine, but to remain in the attitude of outrage, is not that worse still? To fall is bad enough, but why remain fallen? Now it is just this that discouragement produces in my soul. I try very hard to

overcome some fault; perhaps by the kindness of God to a certain extent I succeed: then comes a catastrophe, and I find myself back again in all my old ways. The natural result of this is for me to say that there is no use in my going on trying. I have tried and I have failed: had I not better renounce any further attempts? But "is not sorrow the worst of all our sins?" Is it not far worse in its effects, for it reduces me to such a state of hopelessness that I despair of ever doing any thing again? It is worse, therefore, just in this, that it has a far more disastrous effect upon me. It numbs and paralyzes all effort. Has not the disheartenment that followed sin done me more harm than ever the sin did; driven me from God, or at least kept me at arm's length from God? When I examine my life, I am in common honesty obliged to confess that nothing has done me so much harm, injured my faith and hope and love one half so much, as the state of depression into which I let myself fall.

Cheerfulness, then, and humour, are of very much need in the soul's life. It is the battle half won to enter into it with a smile. To jog on through all the growing weariness of it, to stand the long hours under fire with few opportunities for doing anything, to bear with the dull and comfortless work of the trenches, all this requires a considerable amount of nerve; but it is achieved only through the inspiration of hope. Faced with the wear and tear of it, we

shall surely fail unless we can keep our courage alive. Notice how children smile bravely through their tears, pretending that they are not in pain, when they know that their pain will make others sad, will even make the pain itself harder to bear. Of course, this means and entails a good deal of self-effacement. When self-love is hurt it longs to air its grievances, it longs to tell everyone else of the troubles through which it has passed; nor can it listen in patience to the grumbles of others without wishing at once to answer them with its own tale of suffering. Oh yes, it is not easy to put out of our minds every selfish notice of how others treat us, remembering all that they have done against us, to be patient with the petty ways in which they snub us. Yet all the while we have to carry our trouble patiently and bravely, not letting everyone enter into the secrets of the King. Because I have a headache, is that any reason why everyone else in the house need know about it? Why should I have a consuming desire to tell every person I meet all about my aches and pains? Do I not find it boring when others so pester me? Why, then, should I inflict mine on them? Or, again, my spiritual failings or the progress of my soul, is not that my affair only, mine and God's? All the world's a stage, and I am but a simple actor that must enter smiling, and leave that smile upon the faces of the audience.

The Ethics of Consumption

Towards Better Buying

Arthur Penty

Our thoughtful author wrote at the beginning of the 20th century on the topics of the intersection of economics and politics from a Christian perspective. He was a proponent of guilds as a means of staving off the ravages of the industrial revolution. Man spends most of his time on earth in economic activity, therefore, how can Catholics separate the question of work with the question of salvation? Our author claims that our economic activity should be beautiful, and reintegrates the question of salvation and consumption below. From Old Worlds for New: a Study of the Post-Industrial State published in 1917.

If there is one thing more than another which the experience of the Arts and Crafts Movement has proved conclusively, it is the impossibility of any group of craftsmen, however gifted—and in this connection it is well to remember that the movement secured the active support of the cleverest architects and artists of its day—to effect any widespread reform, apart from the organized support of the public. Without a propaganda movement to teach the public, the craftsman found himself very much at the mercy of the existing demand. A German poet has said that “against stupidity even the gods fight in vain,” and on the aesthetic side of things the British public is peculiarly stupid. It utterly fails, for the most part, to understand the meaning and purpose of art. It fails to realize that beauty and sweetness are essential elements of any human perfection, and that art, when it is vital, enters into every operation of industry, from the making of bricks to the highest flights of the imagination. It conceives of art as a veneer or decoration superimposed upon, or added to something which would otherwise be ugly. The idea that art is organic and inherent in the nature of a thing from the moment of its inception has never so much as entered the public mind. And yet it is precisely the perception of this truth which is the essence of the artist.

He recognizes that there is a right way of doing everything, and that right way is art.

The ordinary British philistine will not admit this. Being without the finer aesthetic perceptions, which alone can enable a man to determine which is the right way of doing things, and lacking that spirit of humility which in the ages of great traditions made him conscious of his ignorance, he seeks to evade the problem by affirming that everything is a matter of taste. In one sense this is true, but not in the sense in which he means it. Every great artist has a personal bias. It is this bias that constitutes his individuality, and we are justified in respecting such differences as arise from the individuality of great artists. These, however, are fundamentally different from the differences which arise from the idle fancies of undisciplined tastes, for the great artist submits his taste to a stern discipline. His spontaneity is the flower of that discipline, and it is just in proportion as a man can submit himself to this discipline that he takes his rank as an artist. I cannot insist too strongly upon the need of recognizing this truth. It is fundamental, and it will remain impossible to restore a tradition of art and handicraft until it is realized. The absence of any such tradition or common language of design is at the root of our difficulties today, for when everyone is, as it were, speaking a different language, artists have little chance of being understood. Now, a tradition bears the same relation to art as the command of language does to speech. Without a language it would be possible for a man to make noises, but words are necessary to enable him to express himself, and he must possess a good vocabulary if he wishes to convey his ideas and to make his meaning clear to others. So in respect to a tradition of art; without it, it is simply impossible for any man to design or express himself intelligently. The only way to recover such a medium of expression for the use of all is by the exercise of a rigid discipline in matters of taste.

When we realize how utterly false is the popular idea of art today, it is not surprising that it is neglected. Truth to tell, insofar as the art of today does approximate to the

popular notion there is no purpose in supporting it. The sooner it dies a natural death the better. But real art is a different matter. No nation neglects its claims without being made to suffer for it, and this not only in the hideousness and rawness of its external life, but in a decline of general intelligence and in the growth of economic difficulties. For all these things are related to each other in subtle ways, and the great thinkers of every age have recognized it. Could we see that terrible monster, modern European materialistic civilization in its true light, we should realize that it owes its existence in no small degree to our neglect of the arts and their sweetening and refining influence. The best proof I can bring of this is that art and our civilization are antipathetic, not merely in the material, but in the spiritual sense. It is impossible to produce beautiful things for people who think like the moderns do when they are determined to have their own way. In this respect, Socialists as a body are no better than other people. Indeed, I often incline to think they are worse; for their habit of relating every evil in society to the growth of the economic problem is apt to blind them to aspects of truth, the recognition of which is not only indispensable to the solution of the problems of art, but of the economic problem itself.

I said that the popular idea of art was that it is a veneer or decoration added to something which would otherwise be ugly. This fallacy ultimately accounts for the neglect of the Arts and Crafts, because it leads the public to suppose that beauty is necessarily expensive. That, of course, is true, insofar as it depends upon honest workmanship and the use of good material, but that is all the truth there is in it. A table may be in good or bad proportion, it may be a pleasing or offensive colour, but neither proportion nor colour has anything to do with the cost. In each case what makes the difference is whether the designer has an eye for these things. Many artistic products are cheap, as the peasant arts of all countries which have not been exploited by commercialism bear witness. But the public neglect them. With their fixed idea that art is something added, and therefore costly, they refuse to buy such things. They prefer shoddy made imitations of more expensive forms of design. The consequence is that beautiful things which are inexpensive tend to go off the market. This stupid attitude of mind makes it difficult for the artist to be perfectly straightforward in his dealings with the public. He never knows what to charge. In many cases, if he charges a fair price and the price is low, they refuse to buy, on the assumption that it is not good work. If, knowing this, he prices his work high, as likely as not they will say that they cannot afford it. In a word, the artist in his dealings with the public today not infrequently finds himself between the devil and the deep blue sea. The public becomes the prey of sharks of all kinds, because it is almost impossible for honest men to handle them. They have only themselves to blame. It is this kind of nonsense that defeated the Arts and Crafts movement in its original intention, and it is this kind of nonsense that the capitalist knows how to exploit. It is the secret of half of his power.

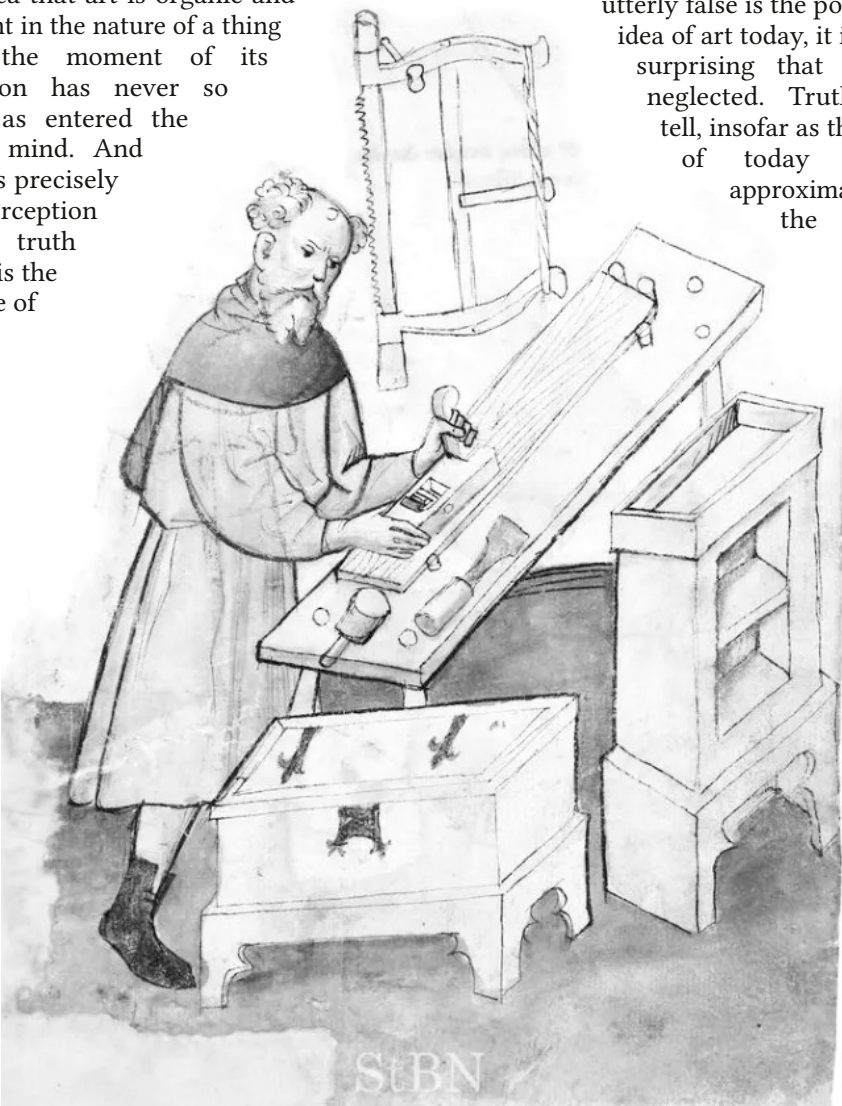
There is another reason for the neglect of the Arts and Crafts. It is a spiritual failure. It is one of the paradoxes of our age that the public do not appear to mind how much they spend upon things of a temporary nature, but they grudge every

“The vast mass of people fritter away their incomes in all kinds of senseless extravagance. They know no limit to personal expenditure, and are mean and contemptible in every other direction.”

penny spent upon things of permanent value. The proprietor of a West-End gallery where works of handicraft are sold, told me recently that ladies who would not mind giving fifteen or twenty guineas for a hat which only lasts a few months and which probably only costs as many shillings to make, yet will consider an article of craftsmanship at a similar price, which represents real value in labour quite apart from its aesthetic qualities, as outside their reach. It is perfectly extraordinary, when you get behind the scenes, to witness the vagaries of the public or to account for their motives in expenditure. No matter how huge a person's income may be nowadays, he rarely thinks he can afford to buy anything of permanent value. The vast mass of people fritter away their incomes in all kinds of senseless extravagance. They know no limit to personal expenditure, and are mean and contemptible in every other direction. And this spirit is not only confined to the rich. It is spreading to every class of society, down to the lowest. Have we not heard what the factory girl spends on dress?

Ruskin spent most of his life in trying to convince people that political economy is a moral science. He went to the root of the problem when he said: “The vital question for individual and nation is not, How much do they make? But, To what purpose do they spend?” It is a fruitful idea, and it receives ample corroborative testimony from the writings of the Chinese philosopher, Ku Hung Ming. He says:—

The final distress of China and the economic sickness of the world today are not due to insufficiency of productive power, to want of manufactures and railways, but to ignoble and wasteful consumption. Ignoble and wasteful consumption in communities, as in nations, means the want of nobility of character in the community or nation to direct the power of industry of the people to noble purposes. When there is nobility of character in a community or nation, people will know how to spend their money for noble purposes. When people know how to spend their money for noble purposes, they will not care for the “what,” but for the “how”—not for the bigness, grandeur, or showiness, but for the taste, for the beauty of their life's surroundings. When people in a nation or community have sufficient nobility of character to care only for the tastefulness and beauty of their life's surroundings, they will want little to satisfy them, and in that way they will not waste the power of industry of the people, such as in building big, ugly houses and making long, useless roads. When the power of industry of the people in a community or nation is nobly directed and not wasted, then the community or nation is truly rich, not in money or possession of big, ugly houses, but rich in the health of the body and the beauty of the soul of its people.... Ignoble and wasteful consumption not only wastes the power of industry of the people, but it makes a just distribution of the fruits of that industry difficult.



A noble mind thinks in terms of eternity: why choose plentiful junk over sufficient craftwork?



Comments on Entryism

Artificiality and Utopianism in the Modern State

Rubén Pérez Gatica

Translated from a recent article featured in La Esperanza a Spanish language magazine and propaganda arm of the Carlist movement, a political and Catholic movement supporting the Carlist line of succession of the Spanish throne, and a return to organic, traditional Spanish society. Entryism is a political strategy of infiltrating to current power structures in order to wield them for benefit. Our author raises some doubts on the long-term viability of such a strategy.

The true utopia does not lie in seeking this or that form of government, but in transforming and molding society in order to change human nature according to a scheme devised by reason alone.

— Traditionalist Circle of the Río de la Plata, Argentina, February 27, 2026

“The so-called new law, presented as an achievement of modern times and the product of progressive liberty, has begun to prevail everywhere. Yet, despite the many attempts that have been made, no superior system for constituting and governing the State has been found than that which springs spontaneously from the doctrine of the Gospel.”

— Leo XIII, *Immortale Dei*.

Previously, it was shown how entryism, by regarding politics as the art of the possible (or of the possible good), prioritizes effectiveness and pragmatism, relegating the end of politics—that is, the common good of society—to something secondary or merely the result of those attainable achievements. The problem this creates is that it relativizes responsibility for those attainable goods, forgetting that human acts—including those of politicians—carry a moral responsibility both with respect to the lawfulness of the act itself and the intention toward which it is directed.

In this sense, the means must be proportionate to the end. This is why Carlism defends traditional society, since it is the spontaneous way in which society organizes itself. Likewise, the form of government is, as a means, a determination of the governing principle through which society is directed in an orderly manner toward the common good—that is, toward the perfection of the nature of its members.

Now, entryists might object: granted, we should not be guided by the amoral rules of modern Machiavellian politics, but why concern ourselves with the form of government? That only diverts attention to something secondary and utopian.

In response, it is necessary to begin with the fact that political society arises from man’s very social nature. Man is not born wild or isolated from others, but rather, by both historical and ontological necessity,

has always been born and developed within society—from the domestic society (the family) to political society (the city or the kingdom). The State, or political society, is therefore the natural union of government, which is necessary to order, direct, and coordinate, together with the various families united and governed by it toward the common good.

Government may take different forms in order to direct society effectively toward the common good while respecting the tradition, character, and circumstances of the people. These forms are monarchy, aristocracy, and democracy (or *politeia*). However, because of Original Sin, man is prone to error and to pursuing false goods. In other words, the natural and traditional social order may be abused by a bad ruler in pursuit of a “good” that does not correspond to the perfection of the members of society. Hence the classical classification of unjust forms: tyranny, oligarchy, and demagoguery.

The rise of rationalism in the sixteenth century intensified this problem. Calderón Bouchet summarizes it as follows:

“Modern thought is born under the influence of the new mathematical and physical sciences, and this practical rather than contemplative origin burdens it with the weight of its first contact, which is constructive and demiurgic.” (*The Empty Suitcase*, Nueva Hispanidad, 2022, p. 95.)

The birth of modern science, accompanied by the rejection of Scholasticism and Aristotelianism, abandoned the importance of final causality and focused instead on understanding efficient causality through the empirical-mathematical method. Nature would thereafter be studied and understood primarily in order to dominate it and extract useful benefits from it.

The scientific advances produced by modern science also generated enthusiasm for a future ordered by human reason:

“Modern thought introduced a new conception of progress in which the significance symbolized by the Cross was explicitly rejected, and mankind was promised a paradise on earth.”

The Argentine scholar continues:

“For that progress to be possible, everything subject to man’s dominating spirit must become like a plastic material.” (Calderón Bouchet, 2022, p. 96.)

Thus, the true utopia does not lie in seeking one form of government rather than another, but in transforming and molding society so as to change human nature according to a scheme devised by reason alone.

The myth of the state of nature (defended by Hobbes and Locke), according to which men were originally born free but, out of a need for security and peace, “contracted” among themselves to safeguard their lives and property in exchange for the unlimited freedom they had previously enjoyed, fundamentally altered the conception of the State. The people and the government were no longer seen as two necessary principles of political society. Instead, the people—a mere aggregation of individuals—voluntarily contracted and delegated power in order to preserve order and each person’s private goods, while the

ruler became the one entrusted with all power to guarantee individuals’ interests and ensure purely earthly progress.

Political society thus ceased to be something natural to man and became an artificial construct—a useful product of contract designed to attain, preserve, and multiply temporal goods rather than to pursue the common good, which is understood as the perfection of the members of society.

This pursuit of technical mastery extended from the physical realm into the social realm and encouraged the State to seek efficiency in the art of governing by rationalizing an exact and effective administration that would enable it to keep everything under control. Political society thus became infected by the modern vice of statism, centralization, and positivism, through which the law:

“would culminate in a system of static and falsely universal legal rules, immutable like the principles of Pure Reason, unsuited to changing historical circumstances.” (Bernardino Montejano, *Ideology, Rationalism, and Reality*, Abeledo-Perrot, 1981, p. 134.)

If the modern State initially identified itself with efficiency and the absolute power of a single ruler, it later found its consolidation in the abstract State of positive law, asserting itself, for example, through the great civil codifications such as those of Austria (1786) and Prussia (1794). Finally, this process of depersonalization and abstraction of power reached its full expression with liberal constitutionalism. The “social contract” ceased to be merely a Rousseauian theory and became the foundational dogma of the State, creating law through popular or national sovereignty as embodied by the constituent assembly acting as the representative of the general will, thereby consummating the definitive rupture with the traditional and natural order.

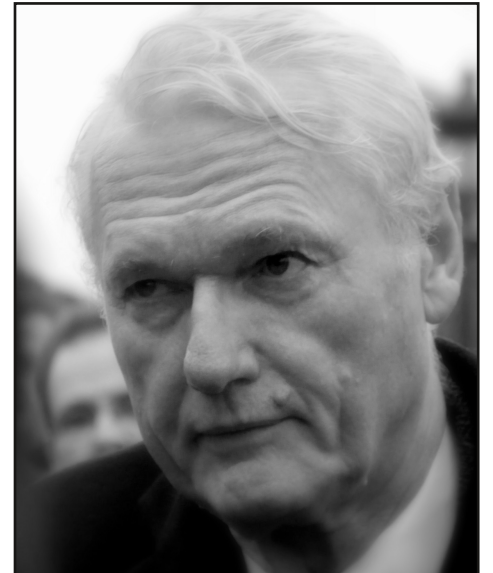
If the constituent assembly, as the embodiment of the nation’s general will, “founds” the law of the State through a social contract (that is, a written constitution), then party politics not only preserves this voluntarist mentality but aggravates it by legitimizing the permanent conflict and alternation of power among right-wing, centrist, and left-wing ideologies (whatever those categories may mean in any given country).

This is what José Miguel Gamba summarizes masterfully when he writes:

“Artificial society, like everything assembled by violating the nature of its parts, always tends toward disintegration, conflict, and anarchy unless it is constantly restrained by the State, its efficient cause. Just like an automobile, which ultimately falls apart unless it continually receives its owner’s maintenance.” (*Traditional Society and Its Enemies*, Ediciones Castellanas, 2021, p. 208)

The modern State is, in short, a vicious artificial construct—a tool of control founded upon erroneous theoretical premises and, in practice, a corrupting principle of society. It materializes in a mode of government that is not ordered toward the common good, but rather toward its own preservation, the pursuit of certain earthly goods, and the utopian dream of

“In response, it is necessary to begin with the fact that political society arises from man’s very social nature. Man is not born wild or isolated from others, but rather, by both historical and ontological necessity, has always been born and developed within society.”

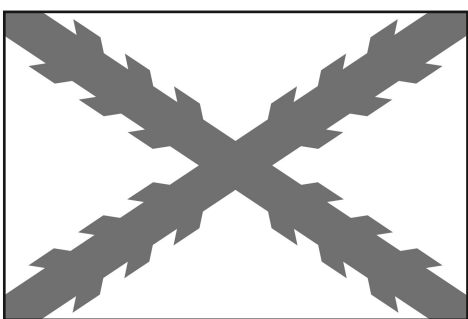


Prince Sixtus Henry, House of Bourbon-Parma, and standard bearer of the Traditionalist Communion of the Spanish Carlists in 2014.

indefinite human progress detached from the divine order.

In response to the entryist objection, it is sufficient to recall the various attempts to use this supposedly neutral construct in favor of society and the common good. Whether in the supposedly restorative approach of strongmen who succeed, for a time, in steering the modern State in a better direction while nevertheless preserving its centralized and efficient machinery—only for that course to collapse once the leader is defeated—or in the party-political approach, in which activists infiltrate political parties believing they can rise through the ranks without compromising their moral principles by allying themselves with publicly impious figures in order to attain and preserve power, producing a political syncretism in which those most willing to practice the immoral rules of Machiavellian politics ultimately prevail.

In conclusion, entryism believes it can make use of the Modern State—whether in its liberal-democratic or totalitarian form—and, through this artificial construct, pursue the political common good, at least to some degree. But just as St. Thomas Aquinas teaches that “art imitates nature,” the political art can neither depend upon nor be built upon an artifact founded on false and erroneous principles, for such an artifact either corrupts or, at best, hinders political action, which ought to be ordered toward the common good of society through the means required by human nature.



The Cross of Burgundy, the current standard of the Carlist Movement. It has long been identified with Imperial Spain.



An older standard of the Carlist Movement. The words *God, Fatherland, King* are emblazoned upon the banner.

Book Review: Piers Plowman

The English Classic by William Langland

Theodore Xavier

Why Langland’s allegorical poem about the spiritual life ought to inspire us today. Langland penned this classic circa 1377, before England had succumbed to the rupture of Christendom during the so called Renaissance. Pre-renaissance works like this prove to us Anglophones that England is a Catholic country, and that Catholicism need not be essentially identified with Mediterranean culture.

Our world is rife with corruption; our Church is rife with scandal. Yet Catholics are called to be *in* this world and not *of* it. How can this be so in these times? To this question, the distant voice of the English poet William Langland cries out to us as a “voice of one crying in the desert” (Matthew 3:3)—the desert of our medieval past. For the series of allegorical visions that Langland presents in his poem *Piers Plowman* are admirable depictions of the pursuit of holiness in a fallen world. Taken together, these visions form an all-encompassing quest for the true spiritual life—one that was not meant for his age alone, but ours as well.

The story begins with the protagonist, Will, falling asleep and experiencing a dream in which he sees “a beautiful field filled with all kinds of people” (pg. 1).¹ Such a detail establishes an important precedent for the rest of this work: its intimate concern is not merely the salvation of one soul, but the sanctification of social life alongside the pursuit of holiness on the individual level. After the Prologue, within which Langland presents the reader with a vivid description of the virtuous and vicious in all ranks of English society, Will is introduced to “a lady with a beautiful face, clothed in a linen dress” (pg. 8) who reveals herself to be Holy Church.

Her role is to provide Will with initial guidance and motivation before he receives further visions that will aid him in his newfound desire to live the true spiritual life. (Incidentally, this plot point echoes the interaction between the analogous figures of Lady Church and the protagonist of the antique *The Shepherd of Hermas*.) Part of Holy Church’s instruction to Will is her explanation of Truth and Love to him:

Truth is a kind of instinctive under-

standing located in the very depths of your heart. It teaches you to love the Lord your God more than your very self, and never to commit a mortal sin, even at the cost of your own life. (pg. 12)

Truth is defined by Holy Church as the *sensus fidelium* on the part of the believer: it is a “kind of instinctive understanding” informed by the Faith, which transcends mere human reason. Hence it encourages the soul to “love the Lord God more than your very self”—for there can be no genuine conflict between Truth and Divine Revelation. Her explanation of Love is also touching. Using an analogy that would have been more readily understood in Langland’s age, she says:

Love is a mediator...like a mayor between the king and the common people. (pg. 13)

Love, then, has an intercessory nature. It is meant to connect, not to rupture; to give, not to take. Intertwined with this point is the Christological connotation that comes with the term “mediator”. Jesus Christ, fully God—and since He is God, He is also Love itself (cf. 1 John 4:8)²—and fully man, mediates for us before His Father in a similar manner to Holy Church’s example of the mayor mediating for the “common people” before the king. The idea of love as mediation is further explored in the poem through its titular character, Piers Plowman.

Will first sees Piers Plowman during a vision within which he witnesses a “myriad of people” who earnestly implore “Christ and his Virgin Mother, asking for grace to go and search for Truth” (pg. 59). Piers knows where to find Truth; he declares that he has been “his follower for the last forty years, sowing his seed and tending his stock” (pg. 60). Allegorically, his decades-long laboring under Truth represents his depth of soul. He is a true veteran of the spiritual life, at the very least.

Thus, Piers is capable of directing these pilgrims on this allegorical pilgrimage to Truth—and not only capable, but *willing*, for he is a man of good will. Describing Truth, he says:

He’s as meek as a lamb and the words he utters are kind. If you want to know

where he lives, I’m more than willing to show you the way. (Ibid)

The language that Piers uses here clearly indicates that Truth is simply Christ by another name: “meek as a lamb” evidently recalls what Our Lord said of Himself: “Take up my yoke upon you, and learn of me, because I am meek, and humble of heart: and you shall find rest to your souls” (Matthew 11:29). By offering to help this crowd find Christ, it is Christ who works through Piers to direct these souls to Himself. Piers therefore takes on the role of a mediator—he is like the mayor that Holy Church describes, for he stands like a priest between these common folk and Christ the King.

But it is not only this crowd who are drawn to Piers: Will finds himself drawn to this holy man as well. Consequently, Will takes the path delineated by Piers, a long arduous adventure wherein he meets all sorts of allegorical figures who either aid or challenge him in his spiritual quest.

Eventually in this pilgrimage, Will encounters a figure named Anima, who represents the soul. During their conversation, Will asks Anima where Charity can be found, since he has struggled to find him on his own. After Anima describes some of Charity’s good works and benevolent nature, Will remarks:

‘Ah Christ!’ I exclaimed, ‘I wish I knew the man! There’s no one in the world I’d rather know!’ (pg. 173)

Which then invites this further dialogue between Anima and himself:

‘But you will never see him in person’, he replied, ‘without the help of Piers Plowman.’

‘But the clergy who look after the Church,’ I returned, ‘do *they* know him?’ ‘The clergy?’ he said, ‘they too have no knowledge of him—except through actions and words. But Piers Plowman has deeper insight into the heart of a man’s intention, and into the reasons why men suffer: “And God saw their thoughts...” (pg. 173)

Thus Anima conveys that Piers Plowman—the holy farmer who symbolizes, as

“Eventually in this pilgrimage, Will encounters a figure named Anima, who represents the soul. During their conversation, Will asks Anima where Charity can be found, since he has struggled to find him on his own.”

Dawson observed in his analysis of this book, “the threefold state of humanity”³—shall serve as Will’s intermediary between Will and Charity. By this, Langland is likely indicating that the will (as in the faculty of the soul) requires more than “actions and words” to unite with the virtue of charity: a “deeper insight” is necessary, an insight that the clergy generally lack because they are found wanting in holiness.

For it is holiness of life that grants one the “deeper insight” which Piers Plowman possesses—and indeed, one can find this “deeper insight” in the saints. After Christ, who understood “the heart of a man’s intention, and the reasons why men suffer” better than the Blessed Virgin Mary? She kept the mysteries of the Child Jesus “in her heart” (cf. Luke 2:19; Luke 2:51); and where most of the disciples fled at the foot of the Cross, she stood firm, witnessing and participating in the mystery of Calvary as she bore her Son’s pains in her heart.

This “deeper insight” is also found with the saints of the lower orders of Paradise. Where Freud and Jung struggled in their Kabbalistic-Gnostic pretenses to understand “the heart of a man’s intention, and the reasons why men suffer”, St. Paul and St. Augustine delivered luminous clarity. The stigmatist saints such as St. Gemma Galgani and Padre Pio likewise revealed a profound understanding of these matters, not *in spite of*, but *because* they bore the wounds of Jesus on their bodies. It is then neither to the worldly nor to the learned we should turn to for answers to the problems of the heart and the soul—it is to the holy.

Following from his answer to Will’s question about the clergy, Anima tells Will:

So, you can never recognize Charity through his outward appearance or his

Continued on Page 7

Of The Various Inclinations Of Children To Virtue, And To Sin

On the Christian and Political Education of Children

Silvio Cardinal Antoniano

Our author was a contemporary and friend of St Charles Borromeo: his work On the Christian and Political Education of Children, published in 1584, is a wonderful testament to the longevity and consistency of not only the theological doctrine of the Church but on her standards and teachings on the morals of a Christian.

Although the seeds of every sin are in us because of the corruption of human nature, there is no doubt that some defects are more proper to one age than to another; Just as we also see that the variety of complexions makes men variously disposed, and more, and less inclined, sometimes to certain affections, and dispositions of virtue, and sometimes to its opposite, so that it is necessary for the

prudent father to observe the nature of his son, which in those early years, not yet accustomed to simulate, and dissimulate, is discovered for itself to those who wait a little for it. And this is the field where the paternal diligence has to toil, moderating with education certain excesses of nature, and correcting as much as possible the defects, and planting the first shoots of some vines, which like small nettles, and thorns, come out. And if in the culture of the earth, and in the generation, and conservation of the herds, and of the flocks, and in the vines, and in the plants, and in the seeds, men have been such curious and diligent investigators, that they have learned to know the various qualities of the land, and of the animals, and of the other things mentioned above, so that from some present signs they will know how to conjecture the future, as for example, they will judge of a foal, whether it

will succeed in being a generous horse, fit for war, and also with art they have found many ways of remedies, to compensate for natural defects. And if these diligences, as I say, have been done, and are being done in the care of the villa, how much more reasonable will it be to strive to know the various inclinations of a child, in order to nourish and increase the good ones, and weaken and perhaps completely eradicate the bad ones? Although it is true that this is not the case with men, who are free and masters of their own affairs, than with wild animals, it is nevertheless true that education is very effective, and is almost another nature, especially when it is used in time, as has been amply explained elsewhere. Therefore, our father should not regret, but rather take pleasure in observing and philosophizing, so to speak, about the nature of his son, beginning from his earliest childhood, and continuing to

observe the progress of nature; which will serve two very important purposes among others. The first will be to discover where it is most necessary to apply the remedy of good discipline. The second will be to conjecture from afar so proportionately about the child, to what manner of life and praiseworthy exercise he will be best able to apply, when he has reached the proper age to be elected, that is, whether he should be a merchant, a doctor, a cleric, or something similar; for it is in the paternal care to accommodate the good inclinations, and to promote them ahead, leading the child along that path where he discovers himself more inclined, and not twisting him to the contrary, for then there is something perfect, and a task, when nature and art are joined together.



Book Review: Piers Plowman Cont.

Continued from Page 6

air of learning; not even through his words or actions, but only through the *will*. And what that is, no living creature knows—save Piers Plowman, “Peter, that is *Christ*.” (pg. 174)

It is “only through the *will*” that Charity can be recognized, for Charity belongs to those of *good will*. Did not the angels announce to the shepherds on the night of the first Christmas: “Glory to God in the highest; and on earth peace to men of good will” (Luke 2:14)? St. Peter received the keys of his office from Jesus because he confessed to Him: “Thou art Christ, the Son of the Living God” (Matthew 16:16). This confession of his belief in Our Lord’s divinity was neither the result of logical deduction nor emotional enthusiasm. It was St. Peter’s response to the gift of faith. Hence why Our Lord told him: “Blessed art thou, Simon Bar-Jona: because flesh and blood hath not revealed it to thee, but my Father who is in heaven” (Matthew 16:17). Those who are animated by good will humbly accept God’s Will; those who are dominated by their flesh and blood are too proud to do so. Holiness therefore neither consists in “outward appearance or air of

learning” nor “actions or words”: it consists in something internal, which is good will—a term easily abused in our time.

Good will is not something that springs up from emotion; it positively responds to the gift of grace. Thus the reader is led back to the lessons that Holy Church gave to Will about Truth and Love. For the *sensus fidelium* of Truth and the mediating power of Love must reside in a soul in order for good will to be present there. But something so interior cannot readily be perceived. Hence Anima states that of this “no creature knows—save Piers Plowman” since his holiness has rendered him an *alter Christus*. It is in the figure of Piers Plowman that Langland finds the key to the Catholic life: a holy laborer, for as Dawson commented, “Christianity is the labour of love”;⁴ Piers produces good works *because* he is a man of good will.

In closing, this medieval masterpiece is surely worth revisiting, and is surely to be recommended for the Catholic student of literature. The Oxford World’s Classics edition is particularly advised for reading, for its rendition of the original Middle English text into modern English and its lengthy notes section. The translation has been done respectfully, and has broadened the accessibility of *Piers Plowman* to the

average person, to whom Middle English practically reads as another language. Complementing this is the notes section located after the text, which thankfully does not attempt to editorialize or reinterpret the Catholic content of this book. Instead, what the translator has provided is a helpful commentary.

The portrait that *Piers Plowman* offers has much to teach us about Langland’s time and ours, especially when it is considered that the author lived through the Great Western Schism, the Crisis of the Church of his age. He did not despair in the midst of such a scandal. On the contrary, his poem reveals him as a man who bewailed the failures of the clergy and layfolk alike while never losing faith in the teachings that they were called to uphold. He saw the key to restoring Christendom in the multifaceted figure of Piers Plowman—the holy man of simple life who, on account of good will, truly becomes a mirror of Christ.

Rightly could these words of St. Paul be applied to Piers: “And I live, now not I; but Christ liveth in me” (Galatians 2:20). Let his character be an encouraging lesson to us to respond to the gift of grace at every opportunity and to participate in the life of Christ through prayer, the sacraments, and

“Langland’s time and ours, especially when it is considered that the author lived through the Great Western Schism, the Crisis of the Church of his age. He did not despair in the midst of such a scandal.”

the Holy Mass. May we, like Piers Plowman, labor under the guidance of Holy Mother Church for the salvation of souls and for a Christendom reborn!

Theodore Xavier is a prolific writer on Catholic and political topics. His works can be found on substack.com/ @theodorexavier

1. All quotations of this text are provided from: Langland, William. *Piers Plowman: A New Translation of the B-Text*. Translated by A. V. C. Schmidt. Oxford World’s Classics. 2009.

2. “He that loveth not, knoweth not God: for God is charity.” — 1 John 4:8

3. “First he appears as man, the child of nature, the peasant who sustains the world by his labour. Secondly, he is the Son of Man and the Son of God who saves the world by his blood...thirdly he is the figure of the Church, the new spiritual humanity, anointed and enlightened by the Holy Ghost to carry on the work of unity and salvation.” Dawson, Christopher. *Religion and the Rise of Western Culture*. Image Books. 1991. pp. 222–223.

4. Ibid. pg. 223.



God speed the plough, and send us corn enough!

August 25: King Saint Louis IX King of France, Soldier of Christ

Fr Alban Butler

From the Benziger Brother Edition of *Lives of the Saints* by Fr Alban Butler.

The mother of Louis told him she would rather see him die than commit a mortal sin, and he never forgot her words. King of France at the age of twelve, he made the defense of God’s honor the aim of his life. Before two years, he had crushed the Albigensian heretics, and forced them by stringent penalties to respect the Catholic

faith. Amidst the cares of government, he daily recited the Divine Office and heard two Masses, and the most glorious churches in France are still monuments of his piety. When his courtiers remonstrated with Louis for his law that blasphemers should be branded on the lips, he replied, “I would willingly have my own lips branded to root out blasphemy from my kingdom.” The fearless protector of the weak and the oppressed, he was chosen to arbitrate in all the great feuds of his age, between the Pope and the Emperor, between Henry III and

the English barons. In 1248, to rescue the land which Christ had trod, he gathered round him the chivalry of France, and embarked for the East. There, before the infidel, in victory or defeat, on the bed of sickness or a captive in chains, Louis showed himself ever the same—the first, the best, and the bravest of Christian knights. When a captive at Damietta, an Emir rushed into his tent brandishing a dagger red with the blood of the Sultan, and threatened to stab him also unless he would make him a knight, as the Emperor Frederick had Facardin, Louis calmly replied that no unbeliever could perform the duties of a Christian knight. In the same captivity he was offered his liberty on terms lawful in themselves, but enforced by an

oath which implied a blasphemy, and though the infidels held their swords’ points at his throat, and threatened a massacre of the Christians, Louis inflexibly refused. The death of his mother recalled him to France; but when order was reestablished he again set forth on a second crusade. In August 1270, his army landed at Tunis, and, though victorious over the enemy, succumbed to a malignant fever. Louis was one of the victims. He received the Viaticum kneeling by his campbed, and gave up his life with the same joy that he had given all else for the honor of God.

Reflection. If we cannot imitate St. Louis in dying for the honor of God, we can at least resemble him in resenting the blasphemies offered against God by the infidel, the heretic, and the scoffer.

Sermon for the Twelfth Sunday after Pentecost

The Abuse of Divine Mercy

St Alphonsus Liguori

From The Sermons of St. Alphonsus Liguori.

"Take care of him." Luke x. 35. In this day's gospel we read, that a certain man fell into the hands of robbers, who, after having taken his money, wounded him, and left him half dead. A Samaritan who passed by, saw him, and taking pity on him, bound up his wounds, brought him to an inn, and left him to the care of the host, saying: "Take care of him." These words I this day address to those, if there be any such among you, who, though their souls are wounded by sin, instead of attending to the care of them, continually aggravate the wounds by new sins, and thus abuse the mercy of God, who preserves their lives, that they may repent, and not be lost forever. I say to you: Brethren, take care of your souls, which are in a very bad state; have compassion on them. "Have pity on thy own soul." (Eccl. xxx. 24.) Your souls are sick, and what is worse they are near the eternal death of hell; for he who abuses to excess the divine mercy, is on the point of being abandoned by the mercy of God. This shall be the subject of the present discourse.

1. St. Augustine says that the devil deludes Christians in two ways "by despair and hope." After a person has committed sin, the enemy, by placing before his eyes the rigour of divine justice, tempts him to despair of the mercy of God. But, before he sins, the devil by representing to him the divine mercy, labours to make him fearless of the chastisement due to sin. Hence the saint gives the following advice: "After sin, hope for mercy; before sin, fear justice." If, after sin, you despair of God's pardon, you offend him by a new and more grievous sin. Have recourse to his mercy, and he will pardon you. But, before sin, fear God's justice, and trust not to his mercy; for, they who abuse the mercy of God to offend him, do not deserve to be treated with mercy. Abulensis says, that the man who offends

justice may have recourse to mercy; but to whom can they have recourse, who offend and provoke mercy against themselves?

2. When you intend to commit sin, who, I ask, promises you mercy from God? Certainly God does not promise it. It is the devil that promises it, that you may lose God and be damned. "Beware," says St. John Chrysostom, "never to attend to that dog that promises thee mercy from God." (Hom. 50, ad Pop.) If, beloved sinners, you have hitherto offended God, hope and tremble: if you desire to give up sin, and if you detest it, hope; because God promises pardon to all who repent of the evil they have done. But if you intend to continue in your sinful course, tremble lest God should wait no longer for you, but cast you into hell. Why does God wait for sinners? Is it that they may continue to insult him? No; he waits for them that they may renounce sin, and that thus he may have pity on them, and forgive them. "Therefore the Lord waiteth, that he may have mercy on you." (Isa. xxx. 1, 8.) But when he sees that the time which he gave them to weep over their past iniquities is spent in multiplying their sins, he begins to inflict chastisement, and he cuts them off in the state of sin, that, by dying, they may cease to offend him. Then he calls against them the very time he had given them for repentance. "He hath called against me the time." (Lam. i. 15.) "The very time," says St. Gregory, "comes to judge."

3. O common illusion of so many damned Christians! We seldom find a sinner so abandoned to despair as to say: I will damn myself. Christians sin, and endeavour to save their souls. They say: "God is merciful: I will commit this sin, and will afterwards confess it." Behold the illusion, or rather the snare, by which Satan draws so many souls to hell. "Commit sin," he says, "and confess it afterwards." But listen to what the Lord says: "And say not, the mercy of the Lord is great; he will have

mercy on the multitude of my sins." (Eccl. v. 6.) Why does he tell you not to say, that the mercy of God is great? Attend to the words contained in the following verse: "For mercy and wrath come quickly from him, and his wrath looketh upon sinners." (Ibid., ver. 7.) The mercy of God is different from the acts of his mercy; the former is infinite, the latter are finite. God is merciful, but he is also just. St. Basil says, that sinners only consider God as merciful and ready to pardon, but not as just and prepared to inflict punishment. Of this the Lord complained one day to St. Bridget: "I am just and merciful: sinners regard me only as merciful." St. Basil's words are: "*Bonus est Dominus sed etiam Justus, nolimus Deum ex dimidia parte cogitare.*" God is just, and, being just, he must punish the ungrateful. Father John Avila used to say, that to bear with those who avail themselves of the mercy of God to offend him, would not be mercy, but a want of justice. Mercy, as the divine mother said, is promised to those who fear, and not to those who insult the Lord. "And his mercy to them that fear him." (Luke i. 50.)

4. Some rash sinners will say: God has hitherto shown me so many mercies; why should he not here after treat me with the same mercy? I answer: he will show you mercy, if you wish to change your life; but if you intend to continue to offend him, he tells you that he will take vengeance on your sins by casting you into hell. "Revenge is mine, and I will repay them in due time, that their foot may slide." (Deut. xxxii. 35.) David says, that "except you be converted," he will "brandish his sword." (Ps. vii. 13.) The Lord has bent his bow, and waits for your conversion; but if you resolve not to return to him, he will in the end cast the arrow against you, and you shall be damned. O God! There are some who will not believe that there is a hell until they fall into it. Can you, beloved Christians, complain of the mercies of God, after he has shown you so many mercies by waiting for you so long? You ought to remain always prostrate on the earth to thank him for his mercies, saying: "The mercies of the Lord that we are not consumed." (Lamen. iii. 32.) Were the injuries which you offered to God committed against a brother, he

"Have recourse to his mercy, and he will pardon you. But, before sin, fear God's justice, and trust not to his mercy; for, they who abuse the mercy of God to offend him, do not deserve to be treated with mercy."

would not have borne with you. God has had so much patience with you; and he now calls you again. If, after all this, he shall send you to hell, will he do you any wrong? "What is there," he will say, "that I ought to do more for my vineyard, that I have not done to it?" (Isa. v. 4.) Impious wretch! What more ought I to do for you that I have not done?

5. St. Bernard says, that the confidence which sinners have in God's goodness when they commit sin, procures for them, not a blessing, but a malediction from the Lord. "*Est infidelis fiducia solius ubique maledictionis capax, cum videlicet in spe peccamus.*" (Serm. iii., de Annunc.) O deceitful hope, which sends so many Christians to hell! St. Augustine says: "*Sperant, ut peccent! Væ a perversa spe.*" (In Ps. cxliv.) They do not hope for the pardon of the sins of which they repent; but they hope that, though they continue to commit sin, God will have mercy upon them; and thus they make the mercy of God serve as a motive for continuing to offend him. Accursed hope! Hope which is an abomination to the Lord! "And their hope will make God hasten the execution of his vengeance; for surely a master will not defer the punishment of servants who offend him because he is good. Sinners, as St. Augustine observes, trusting in God's goodness, insult him, and say: "God is good; I will do what I please." (Tract, xxxiii. in Joan.) But, alas! How many, exclaims the same St. Augustine, has this vain hope deluded! "They who have been deceived by

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St Alphonsus, giving an address to his congregation, the Redemptorists, or The Sons of the Most Holy Redeemer.



Sermon for the Twelfth Sunday after Pentecost Cont.

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this shadow of vain hope cannot be numbered.” St. Bernard writes, that Lucifer’s chastisement was accelerated, because, in rebellion against God, he hoped that he should not be punished for his rebellion. Ammon, the son of king Manasses, seeing that God had pardoned the sins of his father, gave himself up to a wicked life with the hope of pardon; but, for Ammon there was no mercy. St. John Chrysostom says, that Judas was lost because, trusting in the goodness of Jesus Christ, he betrayed him. *“Fidit in lenitate Magistri.”*

6. He that sins with the hope of pardon, saying: “I will afterwards repent, and God will pardon me” is, according to St. Augustine, “not a penitent, but a scoffer.” The Apostle tells us that “God is not mocked.” (Gal. vi. 7.) It would be a mockery of God to offend him as often and as long as you please, and always to receive the pardon of your offences. “For what things a man shall sow,” says St. Paul, “those also shall he reap.” (Ibid., ver. 8.) They who sow sins, can hope for nothing but the hatred of God and hell. “Despisest thou the riches of his goodness, and patience, and long-suffering.” (Rom. ii. 4.) Do you, O sinner, despise the riches of the goodness, of the patience, and long-suffering of God towards you? He uses the word riches, because the mercies which God shows us, in not punishing our sins, are riches more valuable to us than all treasures. “Knowest thou not,” continues the Apostle, “that the benignity of God leadeth thee to penance?” (Ibid.) Do you not know that the Lord waits for you, and treats you with so much benignity, not that you may continue to sin, but that you may weep over the offences you have offered to him? For, says St. Paul, if you persevere in sin and do not repent, your obstinacy and impenitence shall accumulate a treasure of wrath against the day of wrath, that is, the day on which God shall judge you. “According to thy hardness and impenitent heart, thou treasurest up wrath, against the day of wrath, and revelation of the just judgment of God.” (Ibid., verse 5.)

7. To the hardness of the sinner shall succeed his abandonment by God, who shall say of the soul that is obstinate in sin, what he said of Babylon: “We would have cured Babylon; but she is not healed; let us forsake her.” (Jer. li. 9.) And how does God

abandon the sinner? He either sends him a sudden death, and cuts him off in sin, or he deprives him of the graces which would be necessary to bring him to true repentance; he leaves him with the sufficient graces with which he can, but will not, save his soul. The darkness of his understanding, the hardness of his heart, and the bad habits which he has contracted, will render his conversion morally impossible. Thus, he shall not be absolutely but morally abandoned. “I will take away the hedge thereof, and it shall be wasted.” (Isa. v. 5.) When the master of the vineyard destroys its hedges, does he not show that he abandons it? It is thus that God acts when he abandons a soul. He takes away the hedge of holy fear and remorse of conscience, and leaves the soul in darkness, and then vices crowd into the heart. “Thou hast appointed darkness, and it is night: in it shall all the beasts of the wood go about.” (Ps. ciii. 20.) And the sinner, abandoned in an abyss of sins, will despise admonitions, excommunications, divine grace, chastisement, and hell: he will make a jest of his own damnation. “The wicked man, when he is come into the depth of sin, contemneth.” (Prov. xviii. 3.)

8. “Why,” asks the Prophet Jeremias, “doth the way of the wicked prosper?” (Jer. xii. 1.) He answers: “Gather them together as sheep for a sacrifice.” (v. 3.) Miserable the sinner who is prosperous in this life! The prosperity of sinners is a sign that God wishes to give them a temporal reward for some works which are morally good, but that he reserves them as victims of his justice for hell, where, like the accursed cockle, they shall be cast to burn for all eternity. “In the time of the harvest, I will say to the reapers: Gather up the first cockle, and bind it in bundles to burn.” (Matt. xiii. 30.)

9. Thus, not to be punished in this life is the greatest of God’s chastisements on the wicked, and has been threatened against the obstinate sinner by the Prophet Isaias. “Let us have pity on the wicked, but he will not learn justice.” (Isa. xxvi. 10.) On this passage St. Bernard says: This mercy I do not wish for: it is above all wrath. *Misericordiam hanc nolo; super oimiem iram misericordia ista.* (Serin, xlii., in Cant.) And what greater chastisement than to be abandoned into the hands of sin, so that,

being permitted by God to fall from sin to sin, the sinner must in the end go to suffer as many hells as he has committed sins? “Add thou iniquity upon their iniquity... let them be blotted out of the book of the living.” (Ps. lxxviii. 28, 29.) On these words Bellarmine writes: “There is no punishment greater than when sin is the punishment of sin.” It would be better for such a sinner to die after the first sin; because by dying under the load of so many additional iniquities, he shall suffer as many hells as he has committed sins. This is what happened to a certain comedian in Palermo, whose name was Cæsar. He one day told a friend that Father La Nusa, a missionary, foretold him that God should give him twelve years to live, and that if within that time he did not change his life, he should die a bad death. Now, said he to his friend, I have travelled through so many parts of the world: I have had many attacks of sickness, one of which nearly brought me to the grave; but in this month the twelve years shall be completed, and I feel myself in better health than in any of the past years. He then invited his friend to listen to a new comedy which he had composed. But, what happened? On the 24th November, 1688, the day fixed for the comedy, as he was going on the stage, he was seized with apoplexy, and died suddenly. He expired in the arms of a female comedian. Thus the scene of this world ended miserably for him.

10. Let us make the application to ourselves, and conclude the discourse. Brethren, I entreat you to give a glance at all the bygone years of your life: look at the grievous offences you have committed against God, and at the great mercies which he has shown to you, the many lights he has bestowed upon you, and the many times he has called you to a change of life. By this sermon he has Today given you a new call. He appears to me to say to you: “What is there that I ought to do to my vineyard, that I have not done to it?” (Isa. v. 4.) What more ought I to do for you that I have not done? What do you say? What answer have you to make? Will you give yourselves to God, or will you continue to offend him? Consider, says St. Augustine, that the punishment of your sins has been deferred, not remitted; “unfruitful tree! The axe has been deferred. Be

“He that sins with the hope of pardon, saying: “I will afterwards repent, and God will pardon me” is, according to St. Augustine, ‘not a penitent, but a scoffer.’”

not secure: you shall be cut off.” If you abuse the divine mercy, you shall be cut off; vengeance shall soon fall upon you. What do you wait for? Do you wait till God sends you to hell? The Lord has been hitherto silent; but he is not silent forever. When the time of vengeance shall arrive he will say: “These things hast thou done, and I was silent. Thou thoughtest unjustly that I should be like to thee: but I will reprove thee, and set before thy face.”(Ps. xlix. 21.) He will set before your eyes the graces which he bestowed upon you, and which you have despised: these very graces shall judge and condemn you. Brethren, resist no longer the calls of God; tremble lest the call which he gives you today may be the last call for you. Go to confession as soon as possible, and make a firm resolution to change your lives. It is useless to confess your sins, if you afterwards return to your former vices. But you will perhaps say, that you have not strength to resist the temptations by which you are assailed. Listen to the words of the Apostle: “God is faithful, who will not permit you to be tempted above that which you are able.” (1 Cor. x. 13.) God is faithful: he will not permit you to be tempted above your strength. And if of yourself you have not strength to overcome the devil, ask it from God, and he will give it to you. “Ask, and you shall receive.” (John xvi. 24.) “Praising,” said David, “I will call on the Lord, and I shall be saved from my enemies.” (Ps. xvii. 4.) And St. Paul said: “I can do all things in him who strengthened me.” (Phil. iv. 13.) Of myself I can do nothing; but with the divine assistance I can do all things. Recommend yourselves to God in all temptations, and God will enable you to resist them, and you shall not fall.

PUZZLES FOR THE LETTERED FOLK

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- Across**
2) The personal bodyguard of the Holy Father (5-5)
5) Latin word for order, or sequence, usually referring to a calendar (4)
7) Considered the last of the pre-conciliar popes (4-3)
9) From holy tradition, the name of the Mother of the Blessed Virgin (4)
10) An artifact of Arthurian legend, said to help transport the Bread of Angels (5)
11) Grown in Ceylon (3)
12) The adjective form of the secret society guided by judaism for the destruction of Europe and the Church (7)
13) The product of wheat that fueled the Roman Empire (5)
14) Address and title of a monk (7)
16) Are you a man or are you a _____ (5)
17) Men should be able earn enough of a wage so that _____ shouldn't be _____ outside the home. (5-7)
- Down**
1) St Thomas speaks of both _____ and act (7)
2) Product of fat and lye (4)
3) A word meaning 'pardon' (10)
4) A hand-written script of European monks of the early middle ages (6)
6) The Emerald Isle (7)
8) Where the cedar tree grows (7)
11) The worst of civil crimes (7)
13) Anglo-Saxon word for small stream (5)
15) From Greek meaning song of praise (4)

CALTROP SWEEPER

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The Primary Allegiance of The Jews

Parasite or Contributor?

Fr Denis Fahey

From *The Kingship of Christ and Conversion of the Jewish Nation* published in 1953.

The members of the Jewish nation, while retaining their allegiance to their own nation, are also citizens of other nations. Given the messianic aspirations of their own nation they are bound to strive for the domination of their nation over the others, as they are firmly convinced that in this way alone justice and peace will reign upon the earth. The positions attained by them in the councils and legislative assemblies of other nations must logically be for them, at least primarily, means for advancing the domination of their own people. That Christ should reign over nations, in order that the influence of His supernatural life should be felt in all public life, elevating and purifying it, is utterly abhorrent to their naturalism. They entertain considerable contempt for the national patriotism of non-Jews, though in public pronouncements they may pander to it for the sake of their own interests. If the Jews, for example, assisted at a peace conference merely as representatives of a Palestinian state, their role thereat would be proportioned to the importance of that state, but when they assist as secretaries of Lloyd George and Clemenceau and adviser of President Wilson, then we know that English, French and American citizenship will be utilised for the furtherance of the interests of a nation that believes firmly that English, French and Americans are destined by God to be subject to it.

The primary allegiance of an Irishman, who has become a citizen of the United States, is to the United States. He may retain his sympathies with Irish national aspirations, but—to put it mildly—he is not imbued from birth with the idea that the Irish nation is destined to rule over the Americans and all other nations. Besides, if the Irishman in question is still a Catholic and believes firmly in the supernatural Messiah already come, he will be convinced that any subordination of the legitimate interests of the nation of which he is citizen to those of any other nation will be sinful. If, in any public capacity, he found his

sympathies with Irish national aspirations (which, as has been said, do not include a programme of bringing other nations into subjection) coming into conflict with the mission entrusted to him of safeguarding primarily the interests of the U.S.A., he would in conscience be obliged to resign. Otherwise, he would fail in his duty to the supernatural Messiah, our Lord Jesus Christ. The Jew, to be consistent, would fail in his duty to the messias to come, if he did not subordinate the interests of every other nation to those of his own. There is, accordingly, a vital difference of attitude, which has its ultimate ground in the doctrines respectively held with regard to the messias.

It may be well to quote here some prominent Catholic writers who have advocated that the full citizenship of states, accorded to the Jews for the first time by the French Revolution, should be withdrawn from them. In *Les Pourquoi de la Guerre Mondiale*, Mgr. Henri Delassus, Doctor in Theology, writes as follows: “The first thing to do is to change French legislation. French law, for the last 120 years is legalising a falsehood. It considers as French those who are not French, since they are Jews. French legislation should be in harmony with truth. It ought to restore to the Jews their Jewish nationality, in conformity with reason, history, justice and humanity. The legislation introduced by the Revolution represents the Jew as French. He is not French... The Jews must cease to be officers, magistrates, professors, civil servants, barristers, attorneys, doctors in the public service... We must repeal the law by which Jews have been allowed to usurp the title of French citizens and declare them deprived of French citizenship... Without any foolish acceptance of persons, without a trace of inhuman violence, by an abstract legal provision, which cannot wound anybody’s self-love and of which, consequently, nobody can complain, Jewish functionaries must be obliged to resign from Government positions... It is especially to financial centralisation that the Jews owe the greater part of their strength. But that would have been overcome or could not have been maintained without the aid of political centralisation... Without a change in the legislation introduced by the Revolution, the restoration of the French State is impossible.”

Perhaps the most forcible testimony to the necessity of this measure is that to be found in the series of articles contributed to the *Civiltà Cattolica* in October, November and December, 1890. These articles form a complete treatise on *The Jewish Question in Europe*, its causes, its effects and the remedies advocated. After having spoken of various unsatisfactory remedies, the writer continues: “In order that the Christian nations may be delivered from the yoke of Judaism and Freemasonry, which is daily growing more oppressive, the only way open to them is to go back along the road they have traversed, to the point where they took the wrong turning. If the Jews are not rendered harmless by means of special laws depriving them of that civil equality to which they have no right, nothing useful or lasting will be accomplished. In view of their presence in different countries and their unchangeable character of foreigners in every nation, of enemies of the people in every country that supports them, and of a society segregated from the societies amongst which they live; in view of the Talmudic moral code which they follow and the fundamental dogma of their religion which spurs them on to get hold of the possessions of all peoples by any means in their power, as, according to it, they are entitled to rule the world; in view of the fact that the experience of many centuries and our present experience have proved conclusively that the equality of civil rights with Christians, granted them in Christian states, has had for effect the oppression of Christians by them, it follows as a necessary consequence that the only way to safeguard the rights of Christians, where the Jews are permitted to dwell, is to regulate their sojourn by laws such that it will be impossible for them to injure Christians.

“This is what has been done in the past. This is what the Jews have been seeking to undo for the last hundred years. This is what will have to be done over again, sooner or later, whether one likes it or not. The position of power to which the laws inspired by the Revolution have raised them in our day is digging under their feet an abyss just as deep as the height to which they have ascended. When the storm, which they by their display of power are provoking, bursts, they will be hurled down headlong in a catastrophe as unparalleled in their annals as the effrontery with which they are today undermining the life of the nations that have exalted them...”

“It is certain that one of the signs of the end of the world foretold in holy Scripture

“The Jews must cease to be officers, magistrates, professors, civil servants, barristers, attorneys, doctors in the public service.”

is the entrance of Israel into the one true fold. But we are not convinced that there are indications of that conversion visible at present. This people scattered over the face of the earth... is today what it became after the destruction of Jerusalem, without a king, without a priesthood, without a temple, without a native land, and, at the same time, a most bitter enemy of the name and of the Church of Jesus Christ, True God and True Man, crucified by their ancestors. We see no proofs, evident or otherwise, that it is likely to change for the better and welcome as its Saviour that Jesus whom it put to death... It is certain that at present the Jewish Nation as a whole shows an incomparably greater tendency towards the hatred and destruction of Christianity than towards a benevolent attitude to it and a desire to see it prosper.”

Of course, there need not be any difficulty about allowing Jewish non-citizens, who may be temporarily in a country not their own, freedom of worship in their synagogues. That is a totally different question. The point at issue here is the undoing of the naturalistic disorder introduced by the French Revolution. The expression, “separation of Church and State,” is the one used in revolutionary constitutions to cloak the naturalism by which the state rejects the divine plan for order and places itself above the Mystical Body of Christ. Having entered the camp of the natural Messiah, the state as a necessary corollary, admits the Jews to full citizenship, thus allowing them in practice to work for the supremacy of their own nation over the native one and to prepare for the messianic era.

By the fact of the Jews becoming citizens of a Jewish state and ceasing to be citizens of other states another evil can be remedied. The small minority of sincere Jewish converts to Catholicism have always, up to the present, for all practical purposes been excluded from their own nation. The Jews insisted upon the “rights of minorities,” that is, their “rights,” being safeguarded in the treaties at the end of the Great War. We

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NOTE FROM THE EDITOR

Welcome, dear Reader, to the eleventh issue of *The Plough*.

By the time some of you receive your copy, the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary will already have passed. I pray that it was an occasion of many graces for you.

Allow me to be brief this month.

Too easily, we are tempted to inaction. We convince ourselves that action is too difficult, too costly, or of no use. Whereas, in fact, the opposite is true: inaction will be costly, inaction will be too difficult, and, truth be told, we cannot afford not to be active.

Do not live in fear, but be bold. Our baptism was our entrance into the spiritual life—and into the love of God—but it was also our death. It was our death to fear, to our anxieties, and to our impotence. He who is dead but has the love of God has the freedom of the saints. As Christians on earth, we too ought to act with this same freedom.

Our enemies rely on us being fearful. Without any cost on their part, they can render us inert through mere illusion. For the Church's enemies, fear is an option far cheaper than a

multi-million-dollar propaganda campaign or decades of marching through the institutions. Don't do our enemies' job for them!

What is the opposite of fear? It is courage. Courage is a virtue, and therefore a habit, and therefore something that must be repeated and practised.

Courage is not rashness, and yes, of course, we must be prudent. But true prudence is not the rationalising of inaction; true prudence is the will acting under the direction of the intelligence, which has determined the best course toward a concrete end.

So, dear Reader, make a point of practising the virtue of courage. If the company of mortal sin is all too familiar to you, be bold and take courage against it. If your life is in disorder, take the courage to set it awright. And while this work is taking place in private, have the courage to act alongside other men as a corporate body in public. God cannot but bless these efforts.

Thank you for your loyal patronage, dear Reader, and may God bless you.

Editor of The Plough.



Fr Denis Fahey (centre) at the C.S.Sp. Seminary at Kimmage, circa 1950.



The Primary Allegiance of The Jews Cont.

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must insist upon the rights of the minority of Catholic Jews and see that those who accept the supernatural Messiah must have special guarantees against ostracism and social injustice on the part of their own people. The Jewish state cannot treat its minority differently from the way the Jews claimed that they should be treated in the states of Western Europe. They cannot always expect to have it both ways.

The Jewish State

Have the Jews a right to Palestine as the portion of the earth's surface in which they may set up a separate state? It is clear from all that has been said about their rejection

of the true supernatural Messiah that they can no longer lay claim to it by divine right. They were assigned that part of the earth as their inheritance on condition of their being obedient to God. They disobeyed God's command to hear His Son, by their rejection of Our divine Lord before Pilate and on Calvary, and they persist in their disobedience. Accordingly, there can be no question of a right based on a divine promise. In addition, the Arabs have a natural right to the country they have occupied for the last thirteen hundred years. Canon Arendzen wrote as follows on this aspect of the question, in the *Catholic Gazette* of August, 1936: "The Arab population which has occupied the country for the last 1,300 years has definite

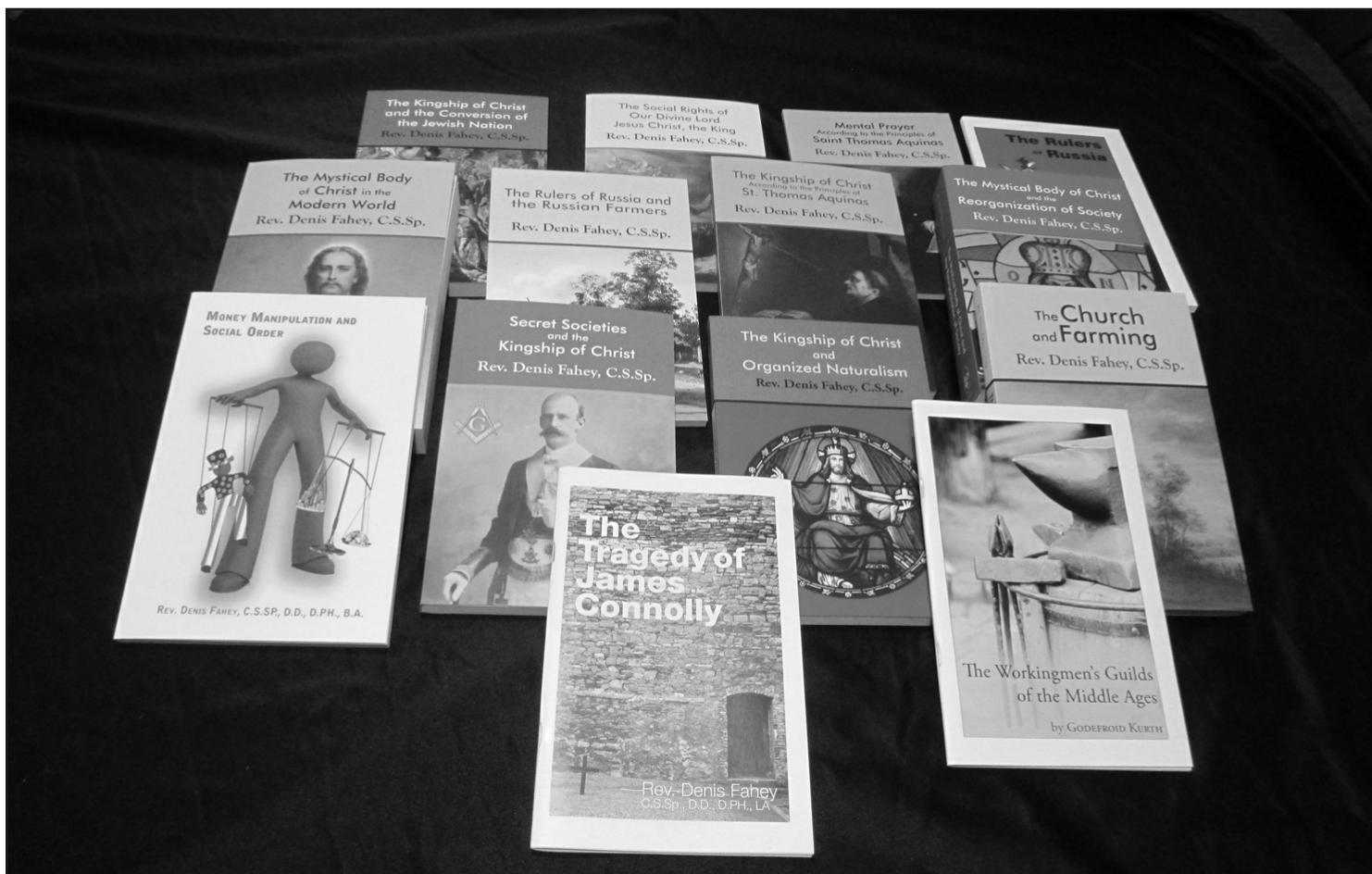
and inalienable rights which must be respected. The Jews are foreigners in Palestine and the intrusion of vast numbers of foreigners so as to swamp the native population seems an act of unprovoked injustice. It would obviously be unfair, if some great power by force made England a national home for the Danes, on the strength of that people once having been masters of this country a thousand years ago. The Jews have practically evacuated Palestine since 138 A.D., and their intrusion into it after having left it for eighteen hundred years seems unjustifiable, on any known principles of equity. The Mandatory power, which at present is the government *de facto*, is clearly acting against elementary laws of fairness in

"The expression, 'separation of Church and State,' is the one used in revolutionary constitutions to cloak the naturalism by which the state rejects the divine plan for order and places itself above the Mystical Body of Christ."

promising to a race, alien in religion, speech and blood, a country already occupied by another nation."

The Jewish claim to Palestine is implicitly a denial that they have disobeyed God and missed their vocation by the rejection of the supernatural Messiah. It is the assertion in action that the promised Messiah has not yet come and that the day of their national domination over the world will yet dawn. The final result will inevitably be another disastrous blow to their hopes, for all their naturalistic attempts to impose their will on God, instead of accepting His, are doomed to failure, and every failure involves the Jewish nation in dire catastrophes.

The writer of the article on the Jewish question in the *Civiltà Cattolica* of 20th December, 1890, already referred to, holds that the once Christian states must go back and take the road they missed at the French Revolution. They must "take away equal citizenship from the Jews, for these latter have no right to it." At the time that article was written the return of the Jews to Palestine had not yet appeared on the horizon. As the attempt to set up a Jewish state in Palestine is an effort to defy God, it has been suggested that some other country should be set aside for the Jewish nation, by international agreement. In that hypothesis all Jews should be citizens of that state only. Very strict regulations should be made concerning the Jews sojourning in states other than the Jewish state.



Fr Fahey's corpus, available at Loreto Publications. This publishing house can be commended for their adherence to the perennial teachings of the Church.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR



International Nowhere Land

Dear Editor,

Thank you for your work in producing *The Plough*—a newspaper I, and I am sure many others, thoroughly enjoy as a source of inspiration in our current times.

I found most interesting the sentiments that were presented in the 'Letters to the Editor' section for the June issue, written by a one 'Little Brother John'. I was hoping there would be some letters in the July issue responding to the invitation: 'I open the floor to other men, and ask for their input on such'. Alas, to my disappointment, there were none. Perhaps they will come in due course. In the meantime, I will take up the invitation and put forward my humble thoughts and ramblings.

"I refuse to stand idly by while the inheritance (my country) I am to present to my children is broken, stolen and burned." It was these words that struck me most in Little Brother John's letter. These are strong words and I would hate for them to go to waste among the many words well phrased of history: they sounded great but

never were realised in action. Action. I think this is an essential part of our answer to solving the anti-Christ control over our disappearing inheritance, both spiritual and temporal. For action is antithetical to idleness. But what does this action look like? I am still figuring this out myself.

I live in a big city in the Anglosphere also, where, like Little Brother John, I can walk through the center of town and see I am a foreigner in my own home. I know this is not right. It would seem St Thomas Aquinas would agree according to the recent article in the July issue. I believe just doing something to start, even if it is not the perfect thing, is better than doing nothing. Perhaps it is having a drink with a like-minded friend to re-assure yourself you are not crazy and alone in your concerns. Perhaps it is getting one's personal life in better order, as order brings about more order; whilst disorder brings about chaos. Perhaps the good Editor and other readers have some suggestions?

The key however, I believe, is to start small. Human nature doesn't dive into the deep end. If the goal is too big, we will either not be bothered or be frightened at

the sacrifices it demands all too soon. I think we are in a time where we will have to make big sacrifices, but best start small today so we will be capable of making these in the future.

Unfortunately, wanting a homeland for your children of those who think alike, look alike, and pray alike, has become taboo. So I am grateful to Little Brother John for broaching the subject and to the good Editor in providing a platform to present these concerns and ideas. I hope more 'Letters to the Editor' make their way into the *The Plough*, on whatever topic, as I believe like-minded Catholic men need each other, even if it is to ask for music recommendations.

Once again, thank you Little Brother John, and thank you good Editor.

— A Fellow Wayfarer.

Thank you for your letter, Fellow Wayfarer.

I am pleased that Little Brother John's letter made an impact on you.

The topic that you raise is a very important one, notwithstanding the far-reaching implications that the

immigration problem has for the restoration of Christendom.

Unfortunately, Catholics today remain, at least in a *de facto* sense, without the guidance of the Church-teaching on this issue.

Because of the gravity and delicate nature of the topic, I think it deserves a deliberate and complete treatment, lest an extemporaneous response fails to do the Catholic Church's teaching justice.

Until then, I reiterate your recommendation to seek out like-minded men and begin building the foundations of corporate action among Catholics of your kinsfolk, so that, with the help of Almighty God and His grace, you may rebuild the natural order according to His wisdom, that He may bless it, and that it may become the diamond in the crown of the new Christendom.

God bless you!

Please visit www.theplough.ink/contribute to send a letter in.

Early Cares Mother and Child

Anonymous Capuchin
From the work Mother Love authored by an anonymous Capuchin brother in 1888.

As soon as the Christian Mother becomes aware that a new being has been engendered in her womb through the power of God, she should immediately offer it up to God, and again and again commend it to His fatherly care and protection in aspirations and words which her own mother-heart suggests. During the months of its development she must carefully avoid unwholesome food, undue exertion, and still more all passionate outbursts of impatience and anger, of grief and worry, of excessive sorrow and care. She must, moreover, refrain from vain and proud thoughts as well as from inclinations and emotions not in keeping with perfect purity. On the other hand, she should constantly strive to remain calm and unruffled in all adverse circumstances, foster a devout and contented disposition, pray earnestly, and receive the Holy Sacraments frequently and worthily; briefly, she should seek to be as she expects her child to be some day. All her troubles and pains and sufferings she should offer to God as so many means to draw down upon herself and her child heaven's choicest blessings and graces, and she should gratefully acknowledge God's goodness not only in joyous events but also in unpleasant and disagreeable affairs.

After the child's birth she should look upon it as a gift of God and as His image, created for His greater honor and glory. She should consider herself as God's agent to whom the child has been entrusted and, therefore, she should love it, watch over it, provide for it, and protect it. All this should be done in a systematic manner and under the guidance of the moral teachings of Holy Church as well as the approved methods of pious and prominent educators.

The newborn child has at best a frail physical constitution and, if it were not tenderly cared for, it would soon become a victim of death. But its spiritual condition is even more delicate. In consequence of the original sin in which it was born, it is a child of wrath, and if it should die in that state, it would be forever deprived of the vision of God and of the incomprehensible happiness and bliss connected therewith. Surely, no truly Christian mother would endanger the eternal happiness of her child by letting it remain in this state of original sin even one day longer than is absolutely necessary.

The first duty, then, of a Christian Mother is to provide for the baptism of her child within one week or, at least, within two weeks after its birth. The baptism must take place in the church of the parish in which the parents live, or in which the child is born. A godfather and a godmother should be provided according to the

instructions of the Church. The godparents should be well instructed in the rudiments of the Faith and also true to its practices, because before God and the Church, they take upon themselves, together with the parents, and second only to these, the responsibility for the Christian education of the child.

The choice of a name for the child is most dear to the mother's heart. It may be her own or that of the father, of one of the sponsors, or of any other, provided that it be the name of a saint whose life-story she knows, to whom she has a great devotion, and from whom she expects for the little newcomer every loving and powerful protection. She may look forward eagerly to the time when she will relate to her child the beautiful incidents in the life of its patron or patroness, and when she will tell of the love and care with which its powerful patron watches over all its footsteps. Even now ardent ejaculations arise from the mother's heart—ejaculations which, later on, will form in the consecrated heart of the child and on its innocent lips those devout aspirations that will pierce the clouds.

At the time of its birth or immediately thereafter the life of the child may be in danger. If such be the case, the mother should at once insist on the private baptism of the child. The minister of the private baptism may be the attending doctor or mid-wife or a relative or one of the attendants; but if none of these would know how to administer private baptism; either the father or the mother should administer the sacrament. The proper manner is the following:

The one who baptizes should take ordinary water, pour it on the head of the child, and, while pouring it, should speak the words:

"I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost."

If the child should recover, it should be taken to church as soon as advisable, to have the ceremonies of solemn baptism supplied. The priest, who performs the ceremony, should be informed of the previous private Baptism and also of the manner in which it was administered.

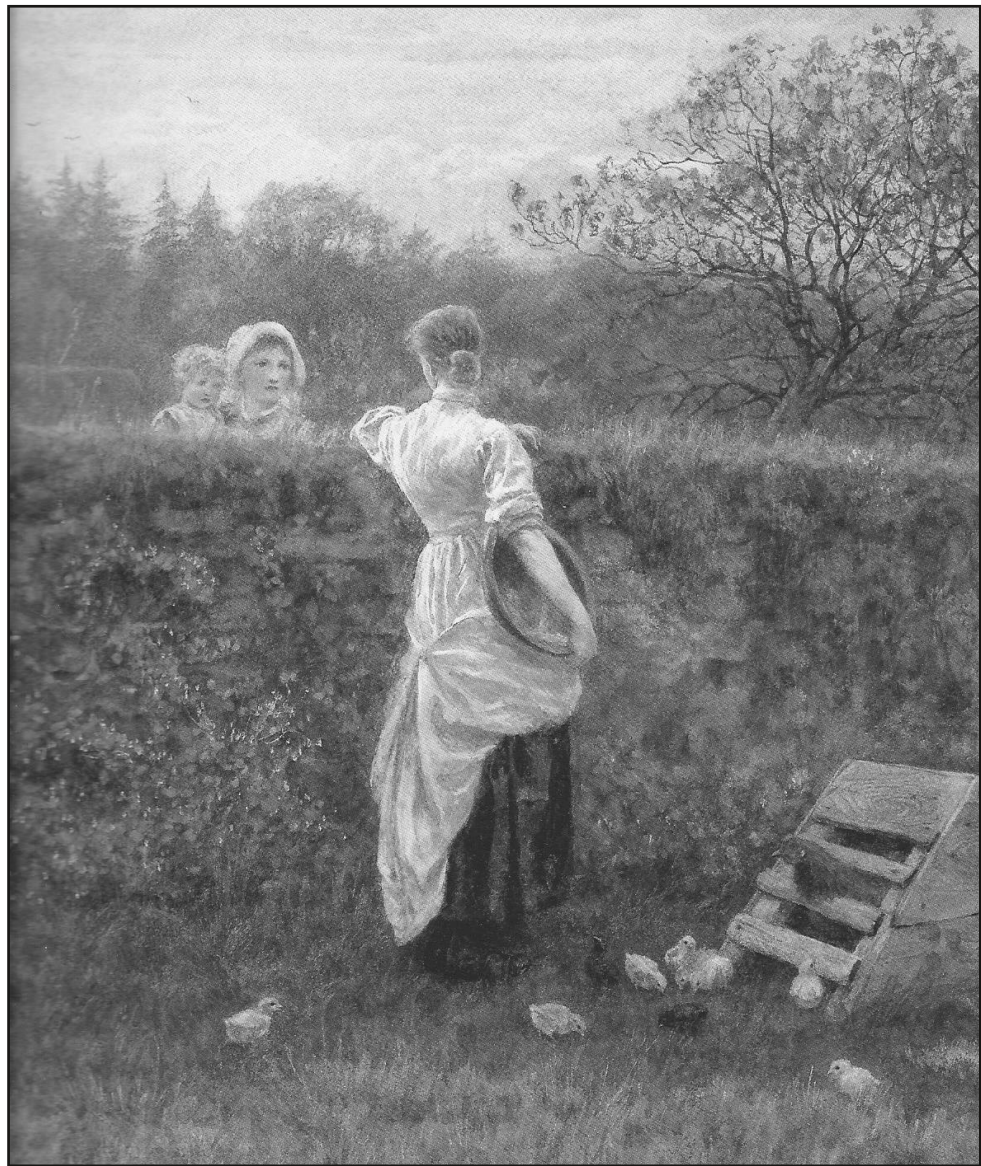
When the child has received holy Baptism, the first and most necessary thing has been accomplished; namely, the greatest evil that had befallen it has been removed, original sin has been removed, it has been washed away, and the wrath of Almighty God has been averted from another of Adam's posterity. The young soul now shines with a luster and beauty that make it more like an angel than a mortal. He may now raise his eyes to Jesus Christ and call Him his Friend, his Brother, and his Spouse. With Jesus' lips and Jesus' Heart and Jesus' confidence, he may now call the Eternal Father his own dear Father and himself His beloved child. He is now all this in perfect truth. Is there a dignity on earth to be compared with this? If emperors and kings had jurisdiction over the whole world, but were not in the state of grace, their honor, majesty, and glory would be far beneath, indeed, would be nothing in comparison with the dignity of this little child of God.

If the child, having received valid Baptism, dies before reaching the age of reason, before being capable of actual sin, it goes straight to heaven, there to praise God among the choirs of blessed spirits. The happiness secured to it for all eternity, no human tongue can express. The delights that earth can offer, the joys of the earthly paradise, all are nothing compared with the felicity prepared by God for His chosen ones in heaven. The difference between the

"The newborn child has at best a frail physical constitution and, if it were not tenderly cared for, it would soon become a victim of death. But its spiritual condition is even more delicate."

former and the latter is far wider, far greater than that existing between a drop of water and the vast ocean, a ray of sunshine and the sun itself.

Whether the child be living or dead, the Christian mother does not neglect, on making her first visit to Church, to beg the priest to church her [i.e. give her the blessing after childbirth, called "the churching of women"]. In either case she owes God thanks for protection and deliverance from greater danger; and she cannot offer thanksgiving more pleasing to God than that which the priest utters over her in the name of the Church. If the child is living, there rests upon her the responsibility of providing for its temporal and eternal welfare; and for this the blessing of the Church is indispensable. Again, her first outing should be to the Church. The priest receives her at the entrance and sprinkles her with holy water as a sign of grace that the Church invokes upon her, and to strengthen her also to receive more efficacious blessings. She is afterward presented with a lighted taper as a sign of the good example which a Christian and a Catholic, and still more a Christian mother, should give her child and her whole family. The priest's stole is then laid on her hand, and she is led to the altar; because the treasures of salvation, which the Church holds for her and her child, are to be dispensed to her by the hand and the power of the priest. Having reached the altar, the priest offers prayers and thanksgivings for her and her child, and ends with reiterated prayers, blessings, and sprinkling with holy water. Christian mother, esteem not as unimportant this touching ceremony instituted by the Church for you alone, and which every priest will, at your request, consider it his duty to perform. Much is contained in it, as well for you as for the child.



The young of the race of men, for longer than any other animal, require the most delicate care and attention of their mother. This is an earthly, but by no means unimportant, work in the life of a woman. But man is not only animal, but also spiritual, and therefore rational. So the material care for her young is not sufficient for the completion of a mother's duties. She must care for her own soul, and for the souls that God has entrusted to her.

PUZZLE SOLUTIONS

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